

Special Expressions

I have decided to call this next section "Special Expressions" only because with the exception of the first few lessons, most of the grammar here applies to more specific areas than the grammar we have covered so far. These special expressions, while individually not vital, are, as a collection, necessary for regular everyday conversations. We are slowly entering the stage where we've built the toolbox and we now need to acquire the little tools that will make the toolbox complete. Now that we covered most of the base, it is time to look at all the little itty gritty bits. You are welcome to skip around the lessons, however; the examples will assume that you have gone over all previous sections.

Causative and Passive Verbs

We will now learn the last two major types of verb conjugations: causative and passive forms. These two verb conjugations are traditionally covered together because of the notorious causative-passive combination. We will now go over what all these things are and how they are used.

Causative Verbs

Vocabulary

1. あげる (ru-verb) - to give; to raise
2. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
3. 全部 【ぜん・ぶ】 - everything
4. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
5. 着る 【き・る】 (ru-verb) - to wear
6. 信じる 【しん・じる】 (ru-verb) - to believe
7. 寝る 【ね・る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
8. 起きる 【お・きる】 (ru-verb) - to wake; to occur
9. 出る 【で・る】 (ru-verb) - to come out
10. 掛ける 【か・ける】 (ru-verb) - to hang
11. 捨てる 【す・てる】 (ru-verb) - to throw away
12. 調べる 【しら・べる】 (ru-verb) - to investigate
13. 話す 【はな・す】 (u-verb) - to speak
14. 聞く 【き・く】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen
15. 泳ぐ 【およ・ぐ】 (u-verb) - to swim
16. 遊ぶ 【あそ・ぶ】 (u-verb) - to play
17. 待つ 【ま・つ】 (u-verb) - to wait
18. 飲む 【の・む】 (u-verb) - to drink
19. 直る 【なお・る】 (u-verb) - to be fixed
20. 死ぬ 【し・ぬ】 (u-verb) - to die
21. 買う 【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
22. する (exception) - to do
23. 来る 【く・る】 (exception) - to come
24. 先生 【せん・せい】 - teacher
25. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
26. 宿題 【しゅく・だい】 - homework
27. たくさん - a lot (amount)
28. 質問 【しつ・もん】 - question
29. 今日 【きょう】 - today
30. 仕事 【し・ごと】 - job
31. 休む 【やす・む】 (u-verb) - to rest
32. その - abbreviation of 「そのの」
33. 部長 【ぶ・ちょう】 - section manager
34. いい (i-adj) - good
35. 長時間 【ちょう・じ・かん】 - long period of time
36. 働く 【はたら・く】 (u-verb) - to work
37. トイレ - bathroom; toilet
38. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go

Verbs conjugated into the causative form are used to indicate an action that someone makes happen. Like Captain Picard so succinctly puts it, the causative verb means to "make it so". This verb is

usually used in the context of making somebody do something. The really confusing thing about the causative verb is that it can also mean to *let* someone do something. Or maybe this is a different type of verb with the exact same conjugation rules. Whichever the case may be, a verb in the causative form can mean either making or letting someone do something. The only good news is that when the causative form is used with 「あげる」 and 「くれる」, it almost always means to "let someone do". Once you get used to it, surprisingly, it becomes quite clear which meaning is being used when.

- 1. 全部食べさせた。
Made/Let (someone) eat it all.
- 2. 全部食べさせてくれた。
Let (someone) eat it all.

Causative Conjugation Rules

Here are the conjugation rules for the causative form. All causative verbs become ru-verbs.

- **For ru-verbs:** Replace the last 「る」 with 「させる」.
- **For u-verbs:** Change the last character as you would for negative verbs but attach 「せる」 instead of 「ない」.
- **Exception Verbs:**
 - 1. 「する」 becomes 「させる」
 - 2. 「くる」 becomes 「こさせる」.

Sample ru-verbs

Plain	Causative
食べる	食べさせる
着る	着させる
信じる	信じさせる
寝る	寝させる
起きる	起きさせる
出る	出させる
掛ける	掛けさせる
捨てる	捨てさせる
調べる	調べさせる

Sample u-verbs

Plain	Causative
話す	話させる
聞く	聞かせる
泳ぐ	泳がせる
遊ぶ	遊ばせる
待つ	待たせる
飲む	飲ませる
直る	直らせる
死ぬ	死なせる
買う	買わせる

Exception Verbs

Positive	Causative
する	させる
くる	こさせる

Examples

Here are some examples using the causative verb. Context will usually tell you which is being meant, but for our purposes we will assume that when the verb is used with 「あげる」 and 「くれる」

(ください) it means "to let someone do" while it means, "to make someone do" when used without it.

1. 先生が学生に宿題をたくさんさせた。
Teacher made students do lots of homework.
2. 先生が質問をたくさん聞かせてくれた。
Teacher let (someone) ask lots of questions.
3. 今日は仕事を休ませてください。
Please let me rest from work today. (Please let me take the day off today.)
4. その部長は、よく長時間働かせる。
That manager often makes (people) work long hours.

When asking for permission to let someone do something, it is more common to use the 「～てもいい」 grammar.

1. トイレに行かせてくれますか。
Can you let me go to the bathroom? (Sounds like a prisoner, even in English)
2. トイレに行ってもいいですか。
Is it ok to go to the bathroom? (No problem here)

A Shorter Alternative

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
3. する (exception) - to do
4. 来る 【く・ る】 (exception) - to come
5. 同じ 【おな・ じ】 - same
6. こと - event, matter
7. 何回 【なん・ かい】 - how many times
8. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
9. お腹 【お・ なか】 - stomach
10. 空く 【あ・ く】 (u-verb) - to become empty
11. 何 【なに / なん】 - what
12. くれる (ru-verb) - to give

There is a shorter version of the causative conjugation, which I will go over for completeness. However, since this version is mostly used in very rough slang, you are free to skip this section until you've had time to get used to the regular form. Also, textbooks usually don't cover this version of the causative verb.

The key difference in this version is that all verbs become an u-verbs with a 「す」 ending. Therefore, the resulting verb would conjugate just like any other u-verb ending in 「す」 such as 「話す」 or 「指す」. The first part of the conjugation is the same as the original causative form.

However, for ru-verbs, instead of attaching 「させる」, you attach 「さす」 and for u-verbs, you attach 「す」 instead of 「せる」. As a result, all the verbs become an u-verb ending in 「す」.

Shortened Causative Form

- This form is rarely used so you may just want to stick with the more traditional version of the causative form.
 - **For ru-verbs:** Replace the last 「る」 with 「さす」.
Example
食べる → 食べさす
 - **For u-verbs:** Change the last character as you would for negative verbs but attach 「す」 instead of 「ない」.
Example
行く → 行か → 行かす
 - **Exception Verbs:**
 1. 「する」 becomes 「さす」
 2. 「くる」 becomes 「こさす」

Examples

1. 同じことを何回も言わすな!
Don't make me say the same thing again and again!
2. お腹空いているんだから、なんか食べさしてくれよ。
I'm hungry so let me eat something.

Passive Verbs

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. 着る 【き・ る】 (ru-verb) - to wear
3. 信じる 【しん・ じる】 (ru-verb) - to believe
4. 寝る 【ね・ る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
5. 起きる 【お・ きる】 (ru-verb) - to wake; to occur
6. 出る 【で・ る】 (ru-verb) - to come out
7. 掛ける 【か・ ける】 (ru-verb) - to hang
8. 捨てる 【す・ てる】 (ru-verb) - to throw away
9. 調べる 【しら・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to investigate
10. 話す 【はな・ す】 (u-verb) - to speak
11. 聞く 【き・ く】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen
12. 泳ぐ 【およ・ ぐ】 (u-verb) - to swim
13. 遊ぶ 【あそ・ ぶ】 (u-verb) - to play
14. 待つ 【ま・ つ】 (u-verb) - to wait
15. 飲む 【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink
16. 直る 【なお・ る】 (u-verb) - to be fixed
17. 死ぬ 【し・ ぬ】 (u-verb) - to die
18. 買う 【か・ う】 (u-verb) - to buy
19. する (exception) - to do
20. 来る 【く・ る】 (exception) - to come
21. ポリッジ - porridge
22. 誰 【だれ】 - who
23. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
24. 変 【へん】 (na-adj) - strange
25. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
26. 光 【ひかり】 - light
27. 速い 【はや・ い】 (i-adj) - fast
28. 超える 【こ・ える】 (ru-verb) - to exceed
29. 不可能 【ふ・ か・ のう】 - impossible
30. 思う 【おも・ う】 (u-verb) - to think
31. この - this (abbr. of これの)
32. 教科書 【きょう・ か・ しょ】 - textbook
33. 多い 【おお・ い】 (i-adj) - numerous
34. 人 【ひと】 - person
35. 読む 【よ・ む】 (u-verb) - to read
36. 外国人 【がい・ こく・ じん】 - foreigner
37. 質問 【しつ・ もん】 - question
38. 答える 【こた・ える】 (ru-verb) - to answer
39. パッケージ - package
40. あらゆる - all

41. 含む 【ふく・む】 (u-verb) - to include

Passive verbs are verbs that are done to the (passive) subject. Unlike English style of writing which discourages the use of the passive form, passive verbs in Japanese are often used in essays and articles.

Passive Conjugation Rules

All passive verbs become ru-verbs.

- **For ru-verbs:** Replace the last 「る」 with 「られる」
- **For u-verbs:** Change the last character as you would for negative verbs but attach 「れる」 instead of 「ない」.
- **Exception Verbs:**
 1. 「する」 becomes 「される」
 2. 「くる」 becomes 「こられる」

Sample ru-verbs

Plain	Passive
食べる	食べられる
着る	着られる
信じる	信じられる
寝る	寝られる
起きる	起きられる
出る	出られる
掛ける	掛けられる
捨てる	捨てられる
調べる	調べられる

Sample u-verbs

Plain	Passive
話す	話される
聞く	聞かれる
泳ぐ	泳がれる
遊ぶ	遊ばれる
待つ	待たれる
飲む	飲まれる
直る	直られる
死ぬ	死なれる
買う	買われる

Exception Verbs

Positive	Passive
する	される
くる	こられる

Examples

1. ポリッジが誰かに食べられた！
The porridge was eaten by somebody!
2. みんなに変だと言われます。
I am told by everybody that (I'm) strange.
3. 光の速さを超えるのは、不可能だと思われる。
Exceeding the speed of light is thought to be impossible.
4. この教科書は多くの人に読まれている。
This textbook is being read by a large number of people.

5. 外国人に質問を聞かれたが、答えられなかった。
I was asked a question by a foreigner but I couldn't answer.
6. このパッケージには、あらゆるものが含まれている。
Everything is included in this package.

Using passive form to show politeness

Vocabulary

1. どう - how
2. する (exception) - to do
3. 領収証 【りょう・しゅう・しょう】 - receipt
4. 明日 【あした】 - tomorrow
5. 会議 【かい・ぎ】 - meeting
6. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go

While we will go over various types of grammar that express a politeness level above the normal -masu/-desu forms in the next lesson, it is useful to know that using passive form is another more polite way to express an action. In Japanese, a sentence is usually more polite when it is less direct. For example, it is more polite to refer to someone by his or her name and not by the direct pronoun "you". It is also more polite to ask a negative question than a positive one. (For example, 「しますか？」 vs. 「しませんか？」) In a similar sense, using the passive form makes the sentence less direct because the subject does not directly perform the action. This makes it sound more polite. Here is the same sentence in increasing degrees of politeness.

1. どう する ? - What will you do? (lit: How do?)
2. どう しますか ? - Regular polite.
3. どう されますか ? - Passive polite.
4. どう なさいますか ? - Honorific (to be covered next lesson)
5. どう なさいますでしょうか ? - Honorific + a lesser degree of certainty.

Notice how the same sentence grows longer and longer as you get more and more indirect.

Examples

1. 領収証はどう されますか ?
What about your receipt? (lit: How will you do receipt?)
2. 明日の会議に 行かれる んですか ?
Are you going to tomorrow's meeting?

Causative-Passive Forms

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
3. 朝ご飯 【あさ・ ご・ はん】 - breakfast
4. 日本 【に・ ほん】 - Japan
5. お酒 【お・ さけ】 - alcohol
6. 飲む 【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink
7. こと - event, matter
8. 多い 【おお・ い】 (i-adj) - numerous
9. あいつ - that guy (derogatory)
10. ～時間 【～じ・ かん】 - counter for span of hour(s)
11. 待つ 【ま・ つ】 (u-verb) - to wait
12. 親 【おや】 - parent
13. 宿題 【しゅく・ だい】 - homework
14. する (exception) - to do

The causative-passive form is simply the combination of causative and passive conjugations to mean that the action of making someone do something was done to that person. This would effectively translate into, "[someone] is made to do [something]". The important thing to remember is the order of conjugation. The verb is first conjugated to the causative and then passive, never the other way around.

Causative-Passive Conjugation Form

The causative-passive verb is formed by first conjugating to the causative form and then by conjugating the result to the passive form.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べさせる → 食べさせられる
2. 行く → 行かせる → 行かせられる

Examples

1. 朝ご飯は食べたくなかったのに、食べさせられた。
Despite not wanting to eat breakfast, I was made to eat it.
2. 日本では、お酒を飲ませられることが多い。
In Japan, the event of being made to drink is numerous.
3. あいつに二時間も待たせられた。

I was made to wait 2 hours by that guy.

4. 親に毎日宿題をさせられる。

I am made to do homework everyday by my parent(s).

A Shorter Alternative

Vocabulary

1. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
2. 立つ 【た・つ】 (u-verb) - to stand
3. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
4. 話す 【はな・す】 (u-verb) - to speak
5. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
6. 廊下 【ろう・か】 - hall, corridor
7. 日本 【に・ほん】 - Japan
8. お酒 【お・さけ】 - alcohol
9. 飲む 【の・む】 (u-verb) - to drink
10. こと - event, matter
11. 多い 【おお・い】 (i-adj) - numerous
12. あいつ - that guy (derogatory)
13. ~時間 【~じ・かん】 - counter for span of hour(s)
14. 待つ 【ま・つ】 (u-verb) - to wait

Going along with the shorter causative alternative, you can also use the same conjugation for the causative-passive form. I won't cover it in too much detail because the usefulness of this form is rather limited just like the shorter causative form itself. The idea is to simply use the shortened causative form instead of using the regular causative conjugation. The rest is the same as before.

Shortened causative-passive form examples

First conjugate to the shortened causative form. Then conjugate to the passive form.

Examples

1. 行~~く~~ → 行~~か~~ → 行か~~す~~ → 行か~~される~~
2. 立~~つ~~ → 立~~た~~ → 立た~~す~~ → 立た~~される~~

This form cannot be used in cases where the shorter causative form ends in 「さす」, in other words, you can't have a 「さされる」 ending.

Verbs that cannot be used in this form

Examples of verbs you *can't* use in this form.

1. 食べる → 食べさす → ~~食べさされる~~
2. 話す → 話さす → ~~話さされる~~

Examples

1. 学生が廊下に立たされた。
The student was made to stand in the hall.
2. 日本では、お酒を飲まされることが多い。
In Japan, the event of being made to drink is numerous.
3. あいつに二時間も待たされた。
I was made to wait 2 hours by that guy.

Honorific and Humble Forms

Japanese can be roughly separated into three levels of politeness: casual, polite, and honorific/humble. So far, we have already gone over the polite forms using 「～です」 and 「～ます」. We will now cover the next level of politeness using honorific and humble forms. You will often hear this type of language in any customer/consumer type situations such as fast food counters, restaurants, etc. For now, the first thing to remember is that the speaker always considers himself/herself to be at the lowest level. So any actions performed by oneself are in humble form while actions performed by anyone else seen from the view of the speaker uses the honorific form.

Set Expressions

Vocabulary

1. する (exception) - to do
2. なさる - to do (honorific)
3. 致す 【いた・す】 (u-verb) - to do (humble)
4. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
5. いらっしゃる - to be; to go; to come (honorific)
6. おいでになる - to be; to go; to come (honorific)
7. 参る 【まい・る】 (u-verb) - to go; to come (humble)
8. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
9. おる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate) (humble)
10. 見る 【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
11. ご覧になる 【ご・らん・になる】 - to see (honorific)
12. 拝見する 【はい・けん・する】 - to see (humble)
13. 聞く 【き・く】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen
14. 伺う 【うかが・う】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen (humble)
15. 言う 【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
16. おっしゃる - to say (honorific)
17. 申す 【もう・す】 (u-verb) - to say (humble)
18. 申し上げる 【もう・し・あ・げる】 (u-verb) - to say (humble)
19. あげる (ru-verb) - to give; to raise
20. 差し上げる 【さ・し・あ・げる】 (ru-verb) - to give; to raise (humble)
21. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
22. 下さる 【くだ・さる】 - to give (honorific)
23. もらう (u-verb) - to receive
24. いただく (u-verb) - to receive; to eat; to drink (humble)
25. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
26. 召し上がる 【め・し・あ・がる】 (u-verb) - to eat; to drink (honorific)
27. 飲む 【の・む】 (u-verb) - to drink
28. 知る 【し・る】 (u-verb) - to know
29. ご存じ 【ご・ぞん・じ】 - knowing (honorific)
30. 存じる 【ぞん・じる】 (ru-verb) - to know (humble)
31. ござる - to be (formal)
32. もう - already
33. 仕事 【し・ごと】 - job
34. 何 【なに / なん】 - what
35. 推薦状 【すい・せん・じょう】 - letter of recommendation
36. 書く 【か・く】 (u-verb) - to write
37. どちら - which way
38. 今日 【きょう】 - today
39. 私 【わたし】 - me; myself; I
40. レポート - report

41. 失礼【しつ・れい】 - discourtesy

The difficult part of learning honorific and humble language is that there are a number of words that have separate verbs for honorific and humble forms. Anything that does not have its own special expression fall under the general rules of humble and honorific conjugations that we will cover next.

Honorific and Humble Verbs

Plain	Honorific	Humble
する	なさる	致す
行く	いらっしゃる / おいでになる	参る
来る	いらっしゃる / おいでになる	参る
いる	いらっしゃる / おいでになる	おる
見る	ご覧になる	拝見する
聞く	-	伺う
言う	おっしゃる	申す / 申し上げる
あげる	-	差し上げる
くれる	下さる	-
もらう	-	いただく
食べる	召し上がる	いただく
飲む	召し上がる	いただく
知っている	ご存知 (です)	存じる

Honorific verbs with special conjugations

A number of these verbs do not follow the normal masu-conjugation rules and they include: 「なさる」、「いらっしゃる」、「おっしゃる」、「下さる」、and 「ござる」 (which we will soon cover). For all masu-form tenses of these verbs, instead of the 「る」 becoming a 「り」 as it does with normal u-verbs, it instead becomes an 「い」. All other conjugations besides the masu-form do not change from regular u-verbs.

ます-conjugations

Plain	ます-form	Past ます-form	Negative ます-form	Past-negative ます-form
なさる	なさ <u>い</u> ます	なさ <u>い</u> ました	なさ <u>い</u> ません	なさ <u>い</u> ませんでした
いらっしゃる	いらっ しゃ <u>い</u> ます	いらっしゃ <u>い</u> ま した	いらっしゃ <u>い</u> ま せん	いらっしゃ <u>い</u> ま せん でした
おっしゃる	おっしゃ <u>い</u> ま す	おっしゃ <u>い</u> まし た	おっしゃ <u>い</u> ませ ん	おっしゃ <u>い</u> ませ ん でした
下さる	下さ <u>い</u> ます	下さ <u>い</u> ました	下さ <u>い</u> ません	下さ <u>い</u> ませんでした
ござる	ござ <u>い</u> ます	ござ <u>い</u> ました	ござ <u>い</u> ません	ござ <u>い</u> ませんでした

Examples of honorific form

We can now begin to see that 「ください」 is just a special conjugation of 「下さる」 which is the honorific version of 「くれる」. Let's look at some actual examples. Since these examples are all questions directed directly to someone (second person), they all use the honorific form.

1. アリスさん、もう召し上がりましたか。 Alice-san, did (you) eat already?
2. 仕事で何をなさっているんですか。 What are you doing at work?
3. 推薦状を書いてくださるんですか。 You're going to give me the favor of writing a recommendation letter?
4. どちらからいらっしゃいましたか。 Where did you come from?
5. 今日は、どちらへいらっしゃいますか。 Where are you going today?

Examples of humble form

The following examples are all actions done by the speaker so they all use the humble form.

1. 私はキムと申します。 As for me, (people) say Kim. (I am called Kim.)
2. 私が書いたレポートを見ていただけますか。 Will I be able to receive the favor of getting my report looked at?
3. 失礼致します。 Excuse me. (lit: I am doing a discourtesy.)

Other substitutions

Vocabulary

1. こちら - this way
2. 私【わたし】 - me, myself, I
3. 部屋【へ・や】 - room
4. ござる - to be (formal)
5. お手洗い【お・て・あら・い】 - bathroom
6. この - this (abbr. of これの)
7. ビル - building
8. ～階【～かい】 - counter for story/floor
9. いい (i-adj) - good
10. よろしい (i-adj) - good (formal)
11. 悪い【わる・い】 (i-adj) - bad
12. すいません - sorry (polite)
13. ごめん - sorry (casual)
14. ごめんなさい - sorry (polite)
15. すみません - sorry (polite)
16. 申し訳ありません【もう・し・わけ・ありません】 - sorry (formal)
17. 言い訳【い・い・わけ】 - excuse
18. 恐れ入ります【おそ・れ・い・ります】 - sorry (formal)
19. 恐縮です【きょう・しゅく・です】 - sorry (formal)
20. ～様【～さま】 - honorific name suffix
21. ～さん - polite name suffix
22. お客様【お・きゃく・さま】 - customer (formal)
23. 神様【かみ・さま】 - god (formal)

In addition to these set expressions, there are some words that also have more polite counterparts. Probably the most important is the politer version of 「ある」, which is 「ござる」. This verb can be used for both inanimate and animate objects. It is neither honorific nor humble but it is a step above 「ある」 in politeness. However, unless you want to sound like a samurai, 「ござる」 is always used in the polite form: 「ございます」.

By extension, the politer version of 「です」 is 「でございます」. This is essentially the masu-form conjugation of 「でござる」, which comes from 「である」 literally meaning, "to exist as" (to be covered much later).

Examples

1. こちらは、私の部屋です。 Over here is my room.
2. こちらは、私の部屋でございます。 This way is my room.
1. お手洗いはこのビルの二階にあります。 The bathroom is on the second floor of this building.

2. お手洗いはこのビルの二階にございます。 The bathroom is on the second floor of this building.

Other examples include 「いい」, which is more formally expressed as 「よろしい」. There are also six different ways to say, "I'm sorry" (not counting 「悪いね」 or slight inflection changes like 「すいません」).

Successively politer expressions for apologizing:

1. ごめん。
2. ごめんなさい。
3. すみません。
4. 申し訳ありません。(申し訳 is the humble form of 言い訳)
5. 恐れ入ります。
6. 恐縮です。

In addition, the politest suffix for names is 「様」, one level above 「さん」. You won't be using this suffix too often in actual speech even if you speak to that person in honorific/humble speech. However, expect to use it when writing letters even to people you are somewhat familiar with. Also, service people such as cashiers or waitresses/waiters will normally refer to the customer as 「お客様」. Of course, royalty and deities are always accompanied by 「様」 such as 「神様」.

Honorific and Humble Conjugations

Vocabulary

1. お酒 【お・ さけ】 - alcohol
2. お茶 【お・ ちゃ】 - tea
3. お金 【お・ かね】 - money
4. 音読み 【おん・ よ・ み】 - Chinese reading
5. 意見 【い・ けん】 - opinion
6. ご飯 【ご・ はん】 - rice; meal
7. 訓読み 【くん・ よ・ み】 - Japanese reading
8. 仕事 【し・ ごと】 - job
9. お好み焼き 【お・ この・ み・ や・ き】 - okonomiyaki (Japanese-style pancake)
10. お土産 【お・ みやげ】 - souvenir
11. 返事 【へん・ じ】 - reply
12. 先生 【せん・ せい】 - teacher
13. 見える 【み・ える】 (ru-verb) - to be visible
14. なる (u-verb) - to become
15. もう - already
16. 帰る 【かえ・ る】 (u-verb) - to go home
17. 店内 【てん・ ない】 - store interior
18. 召し上がる 【め・ し・ あ・ がる】 (ru-verb) - to eat; to drink (honorific)
19. 二重敬語 【に・ じゅう・ けい・ ご】 - redundant honorific
20. 下さる 【くだ・ さる】 - to give (honorific)
21. 少々 【しょう・ しょう】 - just a minute; small quantity;
22. 待つ 【ま・ っ】 (u-verb) - to wait
23. こちら - this way
24. ご覧下さい 【ご・ らん・ くだ・ さい】 - please look (honorific)
25. 閉まる 【し・ まる】 (u-verb) - to close
26. ドア - door
27. 注意 【ちゅう・ い】 - caution
28. よろしい (i-adj) - good (formal)
29. 願う 【ねが・ う】 (u-verb) - to wish; to request
30. する (exception) - to do
31. 聞く 【き・ く】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen
32. こと - event, matter
33. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
34. すみません - sorry (polite)
35. 千円 【せん・ えん】 - 1,000 yen
36. 預かる 【あず・ かる】 - to look after; to hold on to;
37. 致す 【いた・ す】 (u-verb) - to do (humble)

For all other verbs without set expressions, there are conjugation rules to change them into honorific and humble forms. They both involve a common practice of attaching a polite prefix 「御」. In Japanese, there is an practice of attaching an honorific prefix 「御」 to certain (not all) nouns to

show politeness. In fact, some words like 「お酒」、 「お茶」、 or 「お金」 come with this prefix so often that it's become practically the word itself. In general, 「御」 is written in hiragana as either 「ご」 for words read as 音読み (e.g. ご意見、ご飯) or 「お」 for words read as 訓読み (e.g. お金、お仕事) . In fact, you may have been using this prefix already without realizing it like 「お好み焼き」 or 「お土産」 . There are some exceptions to this rule such as 「お返事」 . Luckily since 「御」 is rarely written in kanji, identifying the exceptions should not really be a problem.

Honorific Form

The honorific form of verbs *that are not among the set honorific expressions given above* can be formed in two different ways.

Honorific Conjugation 1: お + stem + に + なる

This kind of makes sense if you think of it as a person becoming the honorific state of a verb. All subsequent conjugations follow the normal rules of conjugating the u-verb 「なる」 . To be honest, this type of sentence formulation is rarely used.

- 先生はお見えになりますか。 Have you seen the teacher?

Honorific Conjugation 2: お + stem + です

1. もうお帰りですか。 You're going home already?
2. 店内でお召し上がりですか。 Will you be dining in?

Service people want to be extra polite so they will often use this type of "double honorific" conjugation or 二重敬語 (in this case, the honorific 「召し上がる」 combined with the honorific conjugation). Whether it's necessary or grammatically proper is another story.

Using 「ください」 with honorifics

You can also use 「下さい」 with a honorific verb by replacing 「になる」 with 「ください」 . This is useful for when you want to ask somebody to do something but still use a honorific verb. Yet another often-used expression.

- 少々お待ちください。 - Please wait a moment.

Similarly, with 「ご覧になる」 , you simply replace 「になる」 with 「ください」 .

- こちらにご覧下さい。 Please look this way.

This works for other nouns as well. For example, riding the trains...

- 閉まるドアにご注意下さい。 Please be careful of the closing doors.

Humble Form

Humble verbs are formed in the following fashion.

Humble Conjugation: お + stem + する

You've probably already heard the first example many times before but now you know exactly where it comes from.

1. よろしくお願いします。 I properly make request.
2. 先生、お聞きしたいことがあります。 Teacher, there's something I want to ask you.
3. すみません、お待たせしました。 Sorry, I made you wait (causative form).
4. 千円からお預かりいたします。 We'll be holding on [from?] your 1000 yen.

You'll hear something like example 4 when, for example, you need to get change after paying 1000 yen. Again, the 二重敬語 where 「する」 has been converted to the humble 「致す」 form when it's already in the お+stem+する humble form. Some Japanese people complain that this makes no sense and that 「から」 should really be 「を」.

Making honorific requests

Vocabulary

1. 下さる 【くだ・さる】 - to give (honorific)
2. いらっしゃる - to be; to go; to come (honorific)
3. なさる - to do (honorific)
4. おっしゃる - to say (honorific)
5. する (exception) - to do
6. いらっしゃいませ - please come in (formal)
7. いらっしゃい - please come in
8. ありがとうございます - thank you (polite)
9. また - again
10. 越す 【こ・す】 - to go over
11. どうぞ - please
12. ゆっくり - slowly

We learned how to make polite requests using 「～ください」 in a previous section and we just looked at how to use honorific verbs with requests as well. However, there is yet another way to make requests using honorific verbs. This grammar only applies to the honorific verbs with special 「～ます」 conjugations that we just covered. This includes 「下さる」、「いらっしゃる」、「なさる」、and 「おっしゃる」. I've never actually seen this used with 「おっしゃる」, but it is grammatically possible.

Making requests for honorific actions

- Conjugate the honorific verb to the special masu-conjugation and replace the last 「す」 with 「せ」 Examples
 1. 下さる → 下さいます → 下さいませ
 2. いらっしゃる → いらっしゃいます → いらっしゃいませ
- An abbreviated and less formal version of this is to simply remove the 「ます」 after conjugating to the special masu-form Examples
 1. 下さる → 下さいます → 下さい
 2. いらっしゃる → いらっしゃいます → いらっしゃい

Now you finally know where grammar such as 「しなさい」 and 「してください」 actually came from. Let's look at a few quick examples.

Examples

You'll probably hear this one a million times every time you enter some kind of store in Japan.

- いらっしゃいませ。 Please come in!

However, a middle-aged sushi chef will probably use the abbreviated version.

- いらっしゃい ! Please come in!

Some more examples...

1. ありがとうございます。またお越しくださいませ。 Thank you very much. Please come again.
2. どうぞ、ごゆっくりなさいませ。 Please take your time and relax.

Unintended Actions

This is the first of many useful tools that will become essential in your day-to-day conversations. We will now learn how to express an action that has taken place unintentionally often with unsatisfactory results. This is primarily done by the verb 「しまう」. Let's look at an example.

Vocabulary

1. 康介 【こう・すけ】 - Kousuke (first name)
2. 宿題 【しゅく・だい】 - homework
3. やる (u-verb) - to do
4. しまう (u-verb) - to do something by accident; to finish completely

康介：宿題をやった？ Kousuke: Did you do homework? アリス：しまった！ Alice: Oh no! (I screwed up!)

Using 「しまう」 with other verbs

Vocabulary

1. しまう (u-verb) - to do something by accident; to finish completely
2. その - that (abbr. of それの)
3. ケーキ - cake
4. 全部【ぜん・ぶ】 - everything
5. 食べる【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
6. 毎日【まい・にち】 - everyday
7. キロ - kilo
8. 太る【ふと・る】 (u-verb) - to become fatter
9. ちゃんと - properly
10. 痩せる【や・せる】 (ru-verb) - to become thin
11. 結局【けっ・きょく】 - eventually
12. 嫌【いや】 (na-adj) disagreeable; unpleasant
13. こと - event, matter
14. する (exception) - to do
15. ごめん - sorry
16. 待つ【ま・つ】 (u-verb) - to wait
17. 金魚【きん・ぎょ】 - goldfish
18. もう - already
19. 死ぬ【し・ぬ】 (u-verb) - to die

When 「しまう」 is used in this sense, it is normal to attach it to the te-form of another verb to express an action that is done or happened unintentionally. As is common with this type of grammar, the tense is decided by the tense of 「しまう」.

1. そのケーキを全部食べてしまった。Oops, I ate that whole cake.
2. 毎日ケーキを食べて、2キロ太ってしまいました。I ate cake everyday and I (unintentionally) gained two kilograms.
3. ちゃんと食べないと、痩せてしまいますよ。If you don't eat properly, you'll (unintentionally) lose weight you know.
4. 結局、嫌なことをさせてしまった。In the end, I (unintentionally) made [someone] do something distasteful.
5. ごめん、待たせてしまっ！ Sorry about (unintentionally) making you wait!
6. 金魚がもう死んでしまった。The goldfish died already (oops).

Using the casual version of 「～てしまう」

Vocabulary

1. しまう (u-verb) - to do something by accident; to finish completely
2. 金魚【きん・ぎょ】 - goldfish
3. もう - already
4. 死ぬ【し・ぬ】 (u-verb) - to die
5. 帰る【かえ・る】 (u-verb) - to go home
6. いい (i-adj) - good
7. 皆【みんな】 - everybody
8. どこか - somewhere (abbr. of どこか)
9. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
10. そろそろ - gradually; soon
11. 遅い【おそ・い】 (i-adj) - late
12. なる (u-verb) - to become
13. また - again
14. 遅刻【ち・こく】 - tardiness
15. する (exception) - to do
16. ごめん - sorry
17. つい - just (now); unintentionally
18. お前【お・まえ】 - you (casual)
19. 呼ぶ【よ・ぶ】 (u-verb) - to call

In casual speech, the 「～てしまう」 is often substituted by 「～ちゃう」 while 「～でしまう」 is substituted by 「じゃう」. Both 「～ちゃう」 and 「～じゃう」 conjugate just like regular u-verbs.

1. 金魚がもう死んじゃった。 The goldfish died already.
2. もう帰っちゃっていい？ Is it ok if I went home already?
3. みんな、どこか行っちゃったよ。 Everybody went off somewhere.
4. そろそろ遅くなっちゃうよ。 It'll gradually become late, you know.

There is yet another very colloquial version of 「～てしまう」 and 「～でしまう」 where it is replaced by 「～ちまう」 and 「～じまう」 respectively. Unlike the cuter 「～ちゃう」 and 「～じゃう」 slang, this version conjures an image of rough and coarse middle-aged man.

1. また遅刻しちまったよ。 Darn, I'm late again.
2. ごめん、ついお前を呼んじまった。 Sorry, I just ended up calling you unconsciously.

Another meaning of 「しまう」

Vocabulary

1. しまう (u-verb) - to do something by accident; to finish completely
2. 宿題 【しゅく・だい】 - homework
3. やる (u-verb) - to do

You may have noticed that 「しまう」 has another definition meaning "to finish something completely". You may want to consider this a totally separate verb from the 「しまう」 we have covered so far. Occasionally but not usually, 「しまう」 will have this meaning rather than the unintended action.

- 宿題をやってしまいなさい。 Finish your homework completely.

Special Expressions with Generic Nouns

We've already learned how to use generic nouns in order to modify nouns. Now we will go over some special expression used with generic nouns.

Using 「こと」 to say whether something has happened

Vocabulary

1. こと - event, matter
2. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
3. 徹夜【てつ・や】 - staying up all night
4. 宿題【しゅく・だい】 - homework
5. する (exception) - to do
6. 一人【ひとり】 - 1 person; alone
7. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
8. パリ - Paris
9. お寿司【お・す・し】 - sushi
10. 食べる【たべ・る】 (ru-verb) - to eat
11. 日本【に・ほん】 - Japan
12. 映画【えい・が】 - movie
13. 観る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to watch
14. ヨーロッパ - Europe
15. いい (i-adj) - good
16. そう - (things are) that way
17. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
18. 見る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
19. ～度【～ど】 - counter for number of times

When you combine 「こと」, the generic word for an event with 「ある」, you can talk about whether an event exists or not.

Examples

1. 徹夜して、宿題することはある。
There are times when I do homework while staying up all night.
2. 一人で行くことはありません。
I never go by myself.

Using the past tense of the verb with 「こと」, you can talk about whether an event has ever taken place. This is essentially the only way you can say "have done" in Japanese so this is a very useful expression. You need to use this grammar any time you want to talk about whether someone has ever done something.

Examples

1. パリに行ったことはありますか。
Have you ever gone to Paris?
2. お寿司を食べたことがある。

I've had sushi before.

3. 日本の映画を観たことないの？

You've never seen a Japanese movie?

4. ヨーロッパに行ったことがあったらいいな。

It would be nice if I ever go to Europe.

5. そういうのを見たことがなかった。

I had never seen anything like that.

6. 一度行ったこともないんです。

I've never gone, not even once.

Using 「ところ」 as an abstract place

Vocabulary

1. 所【ところ】 - place
2. 早い【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
3. 来る【く・る】 (exception) - to come
4. 映画【えい・が】 - movie
5. 今【いま】 - now
6. ちょうど - just right; exactly
7. いい - good
8. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
9. 優しい【やさ・しい】 (i-adj) - gentle; kind
10. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
11. 授業【じゅ・ぎょう】 - class
12. 終わる【お・わる】 (u-verb) - to end
13. これ - this
14. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go

「ところ」 (所) is usually used to indicate a generic physical location. However, it can also hold a much broader meaning ranging from a characteristic to a place in time.

Examples

1. 早くきて。映画は今ちょうどいいところだよ。
Come quickly. We're at the good part of the movie.
2. 彼は優しいところもあるよ。
His personality has some gentle parts too.
3. 今は授業が終ったところです。
Class has ended just now.
4. これから行くところでした。
I was just about to go from now.

Using 「もの」 as a casual feminine way to emphasize

Vocabulary

1. 物【もの】 - object
2. どうして - why
3. 来る【く・る】 (exception) - to come
4. 授業【じゅ・ぎょう】 - class
5. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)

The generic object noun 「もの」 can be used as a casual and feminine way of emphasizing something. This is identical to the explanatory feminine emphasis expressed by the 「の」 particle. Just like the explanatory 「の」 particle, the 「の」 is often changed into 「ん」 resulting in 「もん」. Using 「もん」 sounds very feminine and a little cheeky (in a cute way).

Examples

- どうしてこなかったの？

Why didn't (you) come?

1. 授業があったの。
(I) had class. [feminine explanatory]
2. 授業があったもの。
(I) had class. [feminine explanatory]
3. 授業があったもん。
(I) had class, so there. [feminine explanatory]

Various degrees of certainty

In general, Japanese people don't assert themselves of something unless they are absolutely sure that it is correct. This accounts for the incredibly frequent use of 「～と思う」 and the various grammatical expressions used to express specific levels of certainty. We will go over these expressions starting from the less certain to the most certain.

Using 「かもしれない」 to express uncertainty

Vocabulary

1. 多分 【た・ぶん】 - perhaps; probably
2. 映画 【えい・が】 - movie
3. 観る 【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to watch
4. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
5. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
6. それ - that
7. 面白い 【おも・し・ろい】 (i-adj) - interesting
8. 先生 【せん・せい】 - teacher
9. 退屈 【たい・くつ】 - boredom
10. 食堂 【しょく・どう】 - cafeteria
11. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
12. 雨 【あめ】 - rain
13. 試合 【し・あい】 - match, game
14. 中止 【ちゅう・し】 - cancellation
15. なる (u-verb) - to become
16. この - this (abbr. of これの)
17. 映画 【えい・が】 - movie
18. ～回 【～かい】 - counter for number of times
19. こと - event, matter
20. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
21. あそこ - over there
22. 代々木公園 【よ・よ・ぎ・こう・えん】 - Yoyogi park
23. もう - already
24. 逃げる 【に・げる】 (ru-verb) - to escape; to run away

「かもしれない」 is used to mean "maybe" or "possibly" and is less certain than the word 「多分」. It attaches to the end of a complete clause. For noun and na-adjective clauses, the declarative 「だ」 must be removed. It can also be written in kanji as 「かも知れない」 and you can treat it the same as a negative ru-verb (there is no positive equivalent) so the masu-form would become 「かもしれません」. In casual speech, it can be abbreviated to just 「かも」. There is also a very masculine version 「かもしれん」, which is simply a different type of negative verb.

Expressing uncertainty with 「かもしれない」

- Simply attach 「かもしれない」 or 「かも知れない」 to the clause

Examples

1. 映画を観たかもしれない
2. 彼は学生かもしれない
3. それは面白いかもしれない

- Noun and na-adjective clauses must **not** use the declarative 「だ」

Examples

1. 先生だかもしれない → 先生かもしれない
2. 退屈だかもしれない → 退屈かもしれない

- It can be abbreviated to just 「かも」 in casual speech

Example

1. 面白いかもしれない → 面白いかも

Examples

1. スミスさんは食堂に行ったかもしれません。
Smith-san may have gone to the cafeteria.
2. 雨で試合は中止になるかもしれないね。
The game may become canceled by rain, huh?
3. この映画は一回観たことあるかも！
I might have already seen this movie once.
4. あそこが代々木公園かもしれない。
That might be Yoyogi park over there.
5. もう逃げられないかもしれんぞ。
Might not be able to escape anymore, you know.

Using 「でしょう」 to express a fair amount of certainty (polite)

Vocabulary

1. 多分 【た・ぶん】 - perhaps; probably
2. 明日 【あした】 - tomorrow
3. 雨 【あめ】 - rain
4. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
5. これ - this
6. どこ - where
7. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
8. 休む 【やす・む】 (u-verb) - to rest
9. いただく (u-verb) - to receive; to eat; to drink (humble)

「でしょう」 is used to express a level of some certainty and is close in meaning to 「多分」. Just like 「～です / ～ます」, it must come at the end of a complete sentence. It does not have any other conjugations. You can also replace 「～ですか」 with 「～でしょうか」 to make the question sound slightly more polite and less assuming by adding a slight level of uncertainty.

Examples

1. 明日も雨でしょう。
Probably rain tomorrow too.
2. 学生さんでしょうか。
Are (you) student?
3. これからどこへ行くんでしょうか？
Where (are you) going from here?

If you want to sound really, really polite, you can even add 「～でしょうか」 to the end of a 「～ます」 ending.

- 休ませていただけますでしょうか。 - May I receive the favor of resting, possibly?

Using 「でしょう」 and 「だろう」 to express strong amount of certainty (casual)

Vocabulary

1. 遅刻 【ち・ こく】 - tardiness
2. する (exception) - to do
3. 時間 【じ・ かん】 - time
4. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
5. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
6. これ - this
7. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
8. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
9. 掃除 【そう・ じ】 - cleaning
10. 手伝う 【て・ つだ・ う】 (u-verb) - to help, to assist
11. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
12. そう - (things are) that way
13. どこ - where
14. もう - already
15. 寝る 【ね・ る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
16. 家 【1) うち; 2) いえ】 - 1) one's own home; 2) house
17. 帰る 【かえ・ る】 (u-verb) - to go home

The casual equivalent of 「でしょう」 is surprisingly enough 「でしょう」. However, when you are speaking in a polite manner, the 「でしょう」 is enunciated flatly while in casual speech, it has a rising intonation and can be shortened to 「でしょ」. In addition, since people tend to be more assertive in casual situations, the casual version has a much stronger flavor often sounding more like, "See, I told you so!"

Example 1

A : あっ！遅刻しちゃう！
A: Ah! We're going to be late!

B : だから、時間がないって言ったでしょう！
B: That's why I told you there was no time!

Example 2

A : これから食べに行くんでしょ。
A: You're going to eat from now aren't you?

B : だったら？
B: So what if I am?

Example 3

A : 掃除、手伝ってくれるでしょう。

A: You're going to help me clean, right?

B : え？ そうなの？

B: Huh? Is that so?

「だろう」 means essentially the same thing as 「でしょう」 except that it sounds more masculine and is used mostly by males.

Example 4

A : アリスはどこだ？

A: Where is Alice?

B : もう寝ているだろう。

B: Probably sleeping already.

Example 5

A : もう家に帰るんだろう。

A: You're going home already, right?

B : そうよ。

B: That's right.

Expressing Amounts

This lesson will cover various expressions used to express various *degrees* of amounts. For example, sentences like, "I only ate one", "That was all that was left", "There's just old people here", or "I ate too much" all indicate whether there's a lot or little of something. Most of these expressions are made with particles and not as separate words as you see in English.

Indicating that's all there is using 「だけ」

Vocabulary

1. りんご - apple
2. これ - this
3. それ - that
4. 食べる 【たべ・る】 (ru-verb) - to eat
5. この - this (abbr. of これの)
6. 歌 【うた】 - song
7. 歌う 【うた・う】 (u-verb) - to sing
8. その - that (abbr. of それの)
9. 人 【ひと】 - person
10. 好き 【す・き】 (na-adj) - likable; desirable
11. 販売機 【はん・ばい・き】 - vending machine
12. 五百円玉 【ご・ひゃく・えん・だま】 - 500 yen coin
13. 小林 【こ・ばやし】 - Kobayashi (last name)
14. 返事 【へん・じ】 - reply
15. 来る 【く・る】 (exception) - to come
16. 準備 【じゅん・び】 - preparations
17. 終わる 【お・わる】 (u-verb) - to end
18. ここ - here
19. 名前 【な・まえ】 - name
20. 書く 【か・く】 (u-verb) - to write
21. いい (i-adj) - good

The particle 「だけ」 is used to express that that's all there is. Just like the other particles we have already learned, it is directly attached to the end of whichever word that it applies to.

Examples

1. りんご **だけ**。
Just apple(s) (and nothing else).
2. これとそれ **だけ**。
Just that and this (and nothing else).

When one of the major particles are also applied to a word, these particles must come after 「だけ」. In fact, the ordering of multiple particles usually start from the most specific to the most general.

1. それ **だけは**、食べないでください。
Just don't eat that. (Anything else is assumed to be OK).
2. この歌 **だけを** 歌わなかった。
Didn't sing just this song.
3. その人 **だけが** 好きだったんだ。

That person was the only person I liked.

The same goes for double particles. Again 「だけ」 must come first.

- この販売機だけでは、五百円玉が使えない。
Cannot use 500 yen coin in just this vending machine.

With minor particles such as 「から」 or 「まで」, it is difficult to tell which should come first. When in doubt, try googling to see the level of popularity of each combination. It turns out that 「からだけ」 is almost twice as popular as 「だけから」 with a hit number of 90,000 vs. 50,000.

- 小林さんからだけは、返事が来なかった。
A reply has not come from only Kobayashi-san.

Unlike some particles, you can directly attach 「だけ」 to verbs as well.

1. 準備が終わったから、これからは食べるだけだ。
Since the preparations are done, from here we just have to eat.
2. ここに名前を書くだけでいいですか？
Is it ok to just write [my] name here?

Using 「のみ」 as a formal version of 「だけ」

Vocabulary

1. この - this (abbr. of これの)
2. 乗車券 【じょう・しゃ・けん】 - passenger ticket
3. 発売 【はつ・ばい】 - sale
4. 当日 【とう・じつ】 - that very day
5. 有効 【ゆう・こう】 - effective
6. アンケート - survey
7. 対象 【たい・しょう】 - target
8. 大学生 【だい・がく・せい】 - college student

A particle that is essentially identical both grammatically and in meaning to 「だけ」 is 「のみ」. However, unlike 「だけ」, which is used in regular conversations, 「のみ」 is usually only used in a written context. It is often used for explaining policies, in manuals, and other things of that nature. This grammar really belongs in the advanced section since formal language has a different flavor and tone from what we have seen so far. However, it is covered here because it is essentially identical to 「だけ」. Just googling for 「のみ」 will quickly show the difference in the type of language that is used with 「のみ」 as opposed to 「だけ」.

1. この乗車券は発売当日のみ有効です。

This boarding ticket is only valid on the date on which it was purchased.

2. アンケート対象は大学生のみです。

The targets of this survey are only college students.

Indication that there's nothing else using 「しか」

Vocabulary

1. これ - this
2. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
3. 見る 【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
4. 今日 【きょう】 - today
5. 忙しい 【いそが・しい】 (i-adj) - busy
6. 朝ご飯 【あさ・ご・はん】 - breakfast
7. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
8. 全部 【ぜん・ぶ】 - everything
9. 買う 【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
10. ううん - no (casual)
11. 何 【なに】 - what
12. もらう - to receive
13. 頑張る 【がん・ば・る】 (u-verb) - to try one's best
14. こう - (things are) this way
15. なる (u-verb) - to become
16. 逃げる 【に・げる】 (ru-verb) - to escape; to run away
17. もう - already
18. 腐る 【くさ・る】 (u-verb) - to rot; to spoil
19. 捨てる 【す・てる】 (ru-verb) - to throw away

I carefully phrased the title of this section to show that 「しか」 must be used to indicate the **lack** of everything else. In other words, the rest of the sentence must always be negative.

- これしかない。
There's nothing but this.

The following is incorrect.

- これしかある。
(Should be using 「だけ」 instead)

As you can see, 「しか」 has an embedded negative meaning while 「だけ」 doesn't have any particular nuance.

1. これだけ見る。
See just this.
2. これだけ見ない。
Don't see just this.
3. これしか見ない。
Don't see anything else but this.

Examples

- 今日は忙しくて、朝ご飯しか食べられなかった。
Today was busy and couldn't eat anything but breakfast.

Notice that unlike 「だけ」, it is necessary to finish off the sentence.

- 全部買うの？
You're buying everything?
- 1. ううん、これだけ。
Nah, just this.
- 2. ううん、これしか買わない
Nah, won't buy anything else but this.
- 3. ううん、これしか。
(Wrong, the sentence must explicitly indicate the negative.)

While the major particles always come last, it turns out that 「しか」 must come after 「から」 and 「まで」. A google search of 「からしか」 beats 「しかから」 by an overwhelming 60,000 to 600.

- アリスからしか何ももらってない。
I didn't receive anything except from Alice.

You can also use this grammar with verbs.

- これから頑張るしかない！
There's nothing to do but try our best!
- こうなったら、逃げるしかない。
There no choice but to run away once it turns out like this.
- もう腐っているから、捨てるしかないよ。
It's rotten already so there's nothing to do but throw it out.

「っきゃ」, an alternative to 「しか」

Vocabulary

- これ - this
- 買う 【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
- ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
- こう - (things are) this way
- なる (u-verb) - to become
- もう - already
- やる (u-verb) - to do

「っきゃ」 is another version of 「しか」 that means essentially the same thing and works exactly

the same way. Just substitute 「しか」 with 「つきや」 and you're good to go. This version is a bit stronger than 「しか」 in emphasis but it's not used nearly as often so I wouldn't worry about it too much. I briefly cover it here just in case you do run into this expression.

Examples

1. これは買うつきやない！

There's nothing but to buy this!

2. こうなったら、もうやるつきやない！

If things turn out like this, there nothing to do but to just do it!

Expressing the opposite of 「だけ」 with 「ばかり」

Vocabulary

1. 何【なに / なん】 - what
2. おばさん - middle-aged lady
3. 嫌【いや】 (na-adj) disagreeable; unpleasant
4. 崇【たかし】 - Takashi (first name)
5. ～君【～くん】 - name suffix
6. 漫画【まん・が】 - comic book
7. 読む【よ・む】 (u-verb) - to read
8. カッコ悪い【かっこ・わる・い】 (i-adj) - unattractive; uncool
9. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
10. 麻雀【マー・ジャン】 - mahjong
11. 直美【なお・み】 - Naomi (first name)
12. 遊ぶ【あそ・ぶ】 (u-verb) - to play
13. 最近【さい・きん】 - recent; lately
14. 仕事【し・ごと】 - job

「ばかり」 is used to express the condition where there's so much of something to the point where there's nothing else. Notice this is fundamentally different from 「しか」 which expresses a **lack** of everything else but the item in question. In more casual situations, 「ばかり」 is usually pronounced 「ばかり」 or just 「ばかり」. For example, let's say you went to a party to find, much to your dismay, the whole room filled with middle-aged women. You might say the following.

- 何だよ！おばさんばかりじゃないか？
What the? Isn't it nothing but obasan?

Or perhaps a little more girly:

- いやだ。おばさんばかり。
Eww. It's nothing but obasan.

Examples

- 崇君は漫画ばかり読んでてさ。カッコ悪い。
Takashi-kun is reading nothing but comic books... He's so uncool.

It is quite common in casual speech to end midsentence like this. Notice 「読んでて」 is the te-form of 「読んでいる」 with the 「い」 dropped. We assume that the conclusion will come somewhere later in the story.

1. 彼は麻雀ばかりです。
He's nothing but mahjong. (He does nothing but play mahjong.)
2. 直美ちゃんと遊ぶばかりでしょう！

You're hanging out with Naomi-chan all the time, aren't you!

3. 最近は仕事ばかりだよ。

Lately, it's nothing but work.

Saying there's too much of something using 「すぎる」

Vocabulary

1. 過ぎる 【す・ ぎる】 (ru-verb) - to exceed; to pass
2. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
3. 飲む 【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink
4. 太る 【ふと・ る】 (u-verb) - to become fatter
5. 静か 【しず・ か】 (na-adj) - quiet
6. 大きい 【おお・ きい】 (i-adj) - big
7. 面白い 【おも・ しろ・ い】 (i-adj) - interesting
8. もったいない (i-adj) - wasteful
9. 情けない 【なさ・ けない】 (i-adj) - pitiable
10. 危ない 【あぶ・ ない】 (i-adj) - dangerous
11. 少ない 【すく・ ない】 (i-adj) - few
12. 佐藤 【さ・ とう】 - Satou (last name)
13. 料理 【りょう・ り】 - cooking; cuisine; dish
14. 上手 【じょう・ ず】 (na-adj) - skillful
15. また - again
16. お酒 【お・ さけ】 - alcohol
17. 気 【き】 - mood; intent
18. つける - to attach
19. 気をつける - (expression) to be careful
20. トランク - trunk
21. 入る 【はい・ る】 (u-verb) - to enter
22. 罠 【わな】 - trap
23. 時間 【じ・ かん】 - time
24. 足りる 【た・ りる】 (ru-verb) - to be sufficient
25. 何 【なに】 - what
26. 出来る 【で・ き・ る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
27. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
28. 彼女 【かの・ じょ】 - she; girlfriend
29. 昨晚 【さく・ ばん】 - last night
30. こと - event, matter
31. 全然 【ぜん・ ぜん】 - not at all (when used with negative)
32. 覚える 【おぼ・ える】 (ru-verb) - to memorize
33. それ - that

「すぎる」 is a regular ru-verb written 「過ぎる」 meaning, "to exceed". When 「すぎる」 is attached to the end of other verbs and adjectives, it means that it is too much or that it has exceeded the normal levels. For verbs, you must directly attach 「すぎる」 to the stem of the verb. For example, 「食べすぎる」 means "to eat too much" and 「飲みすぎる」 means "to drink too much". For adjectives, you just attach it to the end after you remove the last 「い」 from the i-adjectives (as usual). One more rule is that for both negative verbs and adjectives, one must remove the 「い」 from 「ない」 and replace with 「さ」 before attaching 「すぎる」. There is no tense

(past or non-past) associated with this grammar. Since 「すぎる」 is a regular ru-verb, this grammar always results in a regular ru-verb.

Using 「すぎる」 to indicate there's too much of something

- **For verbs:** First change the verb to the *stem* and attach 「すぎる」.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べすぎる
2. 太る → 太り → 太りすぎる

- **For na-adjectives:** Attach 「すぎる」. For i-adjectives, remove the last 「い」 first before attaching 「すぎる」.

Examples

1. 静か → 静かすぎる
2. 大きい → 大きすぎる

- **For negative verbs and adjectives:** Replace the last 「い」 from 「ない」 with 「さ」 and then attach 「すぎる」

Examples

1. 食べない → 食べなさ → 食べなさすぎる
2. 面白くない → 面白くなさ → 面白くなさすぎる

- I-adjectives that end in 「ない」 which incorporate the negative 「無い」 such as 「もったいない」 (勿体無い) or 「情けない」 (情け無い) follow the third rule.

Examples

1. もったいない → もったいなさ → もったいなさすぎる
2. 情けない → 情けなさ → 情けなさすぎる

- Most regular i-adjectives such as 「危ない」 or 「少ない」 follow the regular rule (rule 2).

Examples

1. 危ない → 危なすぎる
2. 少ない → 少なすぎる

Examples

1. 佐藤さんは料理が上手で、また食べ過ぎました。
Satou-san is good at cooking and I ate too much again.
2. お酒を飲みすぎないように気をつけてね。
Be careful to not drink too much, ok?
3. 大きすぎるからトランクに入らないぞ。

It won't fit in the trunk cause it's too big, man.

4. 静かすぎる。罠かもしれないよ。

It's too quiet. It might be a trap, you know.

5. 時間が足りなさすぎて、何もできなかった。

Due to too much of a lack of time, I couldn't do anything.

6. 彼には、彼女がもったいなさすぎるよ。

She is totally wasted on him (too good for him).

It is also common to change 「すぎる」 into its stem and use it as a noun.

A : 昨晚のこと、全然覚えてないな。

A: Man, I don't remember anything about last night.

B : それは飲みすぎだよ。

B: That's drinking too much.

Adding the 「も」 particle to express excessive amounts

Vocabulary

1. 昨日【きのう】 - yesterday
2. 電話【でん・わ】 - phone
3. ～回【～かい】 - counter for number of times
4. する (exception) - to do
5. 試験【し・けん】 - exam
6. ため - for the sake/benefit of
7. ～時間【～じ・かん】 - counter for span of hour(s)
8. 勉強【べん・きょう】 - study
9. 今年【こ・とし】 - this year
10. キロ - kilo
11. 太る【ふと・る】 (u-verb) - to become fatter

When the 「も」 particle comes after some type of amount, it means that the amount indicated is way too much. For instance, let's look at the next example.

- 昨日、電話三回もしたよ！
I called you like three times yesterday!

Notice that the 「も」 particle is attached to the amount "three times". This sentence implies that the speaker called even three times and still the person didn't pick up the phone. We understand this to mean that three times are a lot of times to call someone.

1. 試験のために三時間も勉強した。
I studied three whole hours for the exam.
2. 今年、十キロも太っちゃった！
I gained 10 whole kilograms this year!

Using 「ほど」 to express the extent of something

Vocabulary

1. 程【ほど】 - degree, extent
2. 今日【きょう】 - today
3. 天気【てん・き】 - weather
4. それ - that
5. 暑い【あつ・い】 (i-adj) - hot
6. 寝る【ね・る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
7. 時間【じ・かん】 - time
8. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
9. 忙しい【いそが・しい】 (i-adj) - busy
10. 韓国【かん・こく】 - Korea
11. 料理【りょう・り】 - cooking; cuisine; dish
12. 食べる【たべ・る】 (ru-verb) - to eat
13. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
14. なる (u-verb) - to become
15. 歩く【ある・く】 (u-verb) - to walk
16. 迷う【まよ・う】 (u-verb) - to get lost
17. 勉強【べん・きょう】 - study
18. 頭【あたま】 - head
19. いい (i-adj) - good
20. ハードディスク - hard disk
21. 容量【よう・りょう】 - capacity
22. 大きい【おお・きい】 (i-adj) - big
23. もっと - more
24. たくさん - a lot (amount)
25. 曲【きょく】 - tune
26. 保存【ほ・ぞん】 - save
27. 出来る【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
28. 航空券【こう・くう・けん】 - plane ticket
29. 安い【やす・い】 (i-adj) - cheap
30. 限る【かぎ・る】 (u-verb) - to limit
31. 文章【ぶん・しょう】 - sentence; writing
32. 短い【みじか・い】 (i-adj) - short
33. 簡単【かん・たん】 (na-adj) - simple
34. 良い【よ・い】 (i-adj) - good

The noun 「ほど」 (程) is attached to a word in a sentence to express the extent of something. It can modify nouns as well as verbs as seen in the next example.

1. 今日の天気はそれ**ほど**暑くない。
Today's weather is not hot to that extent.
2. 寝る時間がない**ほど**忙しい。

Busy to the extent that there's no time to sleep.

When you use this with conditionals, you can express something that translates into English as, "The more you [verb], the more..." The grammar is always formed in the following sequence: [conditional of verb] followed immediately by [same verb+ **ほど**]

- 韓国料理は**食べれば食べるほど**、おいしくなる。

About Korean food, the more you eat the tastier it becomes.

The literal translation is, "About Korean food, if you eat, to the extent that you eat, it becomes tasty." which essentially means the same thing. The example uses the 「**ば**」 conditional form, but the 「**たら**」 conditional will work as well. Since this is a general statement, the contextual 「**なら**」 conditional will never work. The decided 「**と**」 conditional won't work very well here either since it may not always be true depending on the extent of the action.

1. **歩いたら歩くほど**、迷ってしまった。

The more I walked, the more I got lost.

2. 勉強を**すればするほど**、頭がよくなるよ。

The more you study, the more you will become smarter.

You can also use this grammar with i-adjectives by using the 「**ば**」 conditional.

1. iPodは、ハードディスクの容量が**大きければ大きいほど**もっとたくさんの曲が保存できます。

About iPod, the larger the hard disk capacity, the more songs you can save.

2. 航空券は**安ければ安いほど**いいとは限らない。

It's not necessarily the case that the cheaper the ticket, the better it is.

For na-adjectives, since you can't use the 「**ば**」 conditional you have to resort to the 「**なら**」 conditional. Because it sounds strange to use the 「**なら**」 conditional in this fashion, you will hardly ever see this grammar used with na-adjectives. Since 「**ほど**」 is treated as a noun, make sure you don't forget to use 「**な**」 to attach the noun to the na-adjective.

- 文章は、短ければ短いほど、**簡単なら簡単なほど**よいです。

The shorter and simpler the sentences, the better it is.

Using 「～さ」 with adjectives to indicate an amount

Vocabulary

1. 高い 【たか・ い】 (i-adj) - high; tall; expensive
2. 低い 【ひく・ い】 (i-adj) - short
3. 穏やか 【おだ・ やか】 (na-adj) - calm, peaceful
4. この - this (abbr. of これの)
5. ビル - building
6. 何 【なに / なん】 - what
7. 犬 【いぬ】 - dog
8. 聴覚 【ちょう・ かく】 - sense of hearing
9. 敏感 【びん・ かん】 (na-adj) - sensitive
10. 人間 【にん・ げん】 - human
11. 比べる 【くら・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to compare
12. はるか - far more
13. 上 【うえ】 - above

We will now learn how to add 「さ」 to adjectives to indicate an amount of that adjective. For example, we can attach 「さ」 to the adjective for "high" in order to get "height". Instead of looking at the height, we can even attach 「さ」 to the adjective for "low" to focus on the amount of lowness as opposed to the amount of highness. In fact, there is nothing to stop us from using this with any adjective to indicate an amount of that adjective. The result becomes a regular noun indicating the amount of that adjective.

Adding 「～さ」 to adjectives to indicate an amount

- **For i-adjectives:** First remove the trailing 「い」 from the i-adjective and then attach 「さ」

1. 高~~い~~ → 高~~い~~さ
2. 低~~い~~ → 低~~い~~さ

- **For na-adjectives:** Just attach 「さ」 to the end of the na-adjective

Example

1. 穏やか → 穏やか~~い~~さ

The result becomes a regular noun.

Examples

1. このビルの高さは何ですか？

What is the height of this building?

2. 犬の聴覚の敏感さを人間と比べると、はるかに上だ。

If you compare the level of sensitivity of hearing of dogs to humans, it is far above.

Similarity or hearsay

In Japanese there are many different ways to express likeness or similarity depending on appearance, behavior, or outcome. When learning these expressions for the first time, it is difficult to understand what the differences are between them because they all translate to the same thing in English. This lesson is designed to study the differences between these expressions so that you can start to get a sense of which is appropriate for what you want to say.

Expressing similarity with よう (様)

Vocabulary

1. ここ - here
2. 誰【だれ】 - who
3. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
4. 映画【えい・が】 - movie
5. 観る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to watch
6. 学生【がく・せい】 - student
7. 静か【しず・か】 (na-adj) - quiet
8. あの - that (over there) (abbr. of あれの)
9. 人【ひと】 - person
10. 見る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
11. 気【き】 - mood; intent
12. する (exception) - to do
13. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
14. 雰囲気【ふん・い・き】 - atmosphere; mood
15. ちょっと - a little
16. 怒る【おこ・る】 (u-verb) - to get angry
17. 聞こえる【き・こえる】 (ru-verb) - to be audible
18. 何【なに / なん】 - what
19. 起こる【おこ・る】 (u-verb) - to happen
20. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say

We've already briefly gone over 「よう」 and learned that 「よう」 means an appearance or manner. We can use this definition to say that something has an appearance or manner of a certain state. This word can be used in many ways to express similarity. The simplest example is by directly modifying the relative clause. When the sentence ends in 「よう」, you must explicitly express the state-of-being by adding 「だ」, 「です」, or 「でございます」.

1. ここには、誰もいないようだ。

Looks like no one is here.

2. 映画を観たようです。

Looks like (he) watched the movie.

When directly modifying nouns or na-adjectives, you must use the 「の」 particle for nouns or attach 「な」 to na-adjectives.

1. 学生のようだ。

Looks like it's a student.

2. ここは静かなようだ。

Looks like it's quiet.

Notice that example 1 does not say that the person looks *like a student*. Rather, the declarative

「だ」 states that the person appears to *be a student*. On a side note, you can't say 「おいしいよ
うだ」 to say that something looks tasty. This is like saying, "This dish apparently is tasty," which
can actually be kind of rude.

You can also use it as a na-adjective to describe something that appears to be something else.

1. あの人を見たような気がした。
Had a feeling like I saw that person before.
2. 彼は学生のようなな雰囲気ですね。
He has a student-like atmosphere.

Finally, we can attach the target particle to say things like, "I heard it like that" or "I said it like...".

1. ちょっと怒ったように聞こえた。
Was able to hear it like (she) was a little mad.
2. 何も起こらなかったように言った。
Said (it) like nothing happened.

Using 「みたい」 to say something looks like something else

Vocabulary

1. 見る【み・る】(ru-verb) - to see
2. 犬【いぬ】 - dog
3. もう - already
4. 売り切れ【う・り・き・れ】 - sold out
5. 制服【せい・ふく】 - uniform
6. 着る【き・る】(ru-verb) - to wear
7. 姿【すがた】 - figure
8. 学生【がく・せい】 - student
9. この - this (abbr. of これの)
10. ピザ - pizza
11. お好み焼き【お・この・み・や・き】 - okonomiyaki (Japanese-style pancake)
12. 見える【み・える】(ru-verb) - to be visible

Another way to express similarity which is considered more casual is by using 「みたい」. Do not confuse this with the 「たい」 conjugation of 「見る」. The main difference is that this 「みたい」 can be attached directly to nouns, adjectives, and verbs just like particles which i-adjectives like 「～たい」 obviously can't do.

Using 「みたい」 to say something looks like something else

Attach 「みたい」 to the noun that bears the resemblance. 「みたい」 conjugates like a noun or na-adjective and not an i-adjective.

Conjugation Example with 「犬」

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	犬みたい looks like a dog	犬 <u>じゃない</u> みたい doesn't look like a dog
Past	犬 <u>だった</u> みたい looked like a dog	犬 <u>じゃなかった</u> みたい didn't look like a dog

Examples

1. もう売り切れみたい。
Looks like it's sold out already.
2. 制服を着ている姿をみると、学生みたいです。

Looking at the uniform-wearing figure, (person) looks like a student.

The implied meaning here is the person wearing the uniform is not really a student because he/she only *looks* like a student. This is different from example 3 from the previous 「よう」 section which implied that the person appears to be (but might not be) a student. Again, we also can't say 「おいしいみたい」 to say that something looks tasty because it implies that, in actuality, the food might not be so good.

Don't forget that 「みたい」 does not conjugate like the 「～たい」 form or i-adjectives.

- このピザはお好み焼きみたくない？
(みたい conjugates like a na-adjective.)
- このピザはお好み焼きみたいじゃない？
Doesn't this pizza looks like okonomiyaki?

「みたい」 is a grammar used mostly for conversational Japanese. Do not use it in essays, articles, or anything that needs to sound authoritative. You can use 「よう」 instead in the following fashion.

1. もう売り切れのようだ。
It appears that it is sold-out already.
2. このピザはお好み焼きのように見える。
This pizza looks like okonomiyaki.

Guessing at an outcome using 「～そう」

Vocabulary

1. いい (i-adj) - good
2. バランス - balance
3. 崩れる 【くず・れる】 (ru-verb) - to collapse; to crumble
4. 一瞬 【いつ・しゅん】 - an instant
5. 倒れる 【たお・れる】 (ru-verb) - to collapse; to fall
6. この - this (abbr. of これの)
7. 辺り 【あた・り】 - vicinity
8. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
9. 漬物 【つけ・もの】 - pickled vegetable
10. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
11. これ - this
12. 結構 【けっ・こう】 - fairly, reasonably
13. やはり / やっぱり - as I thought
14. 高い 【たか・い】 (i-adj) - high; tall; expensive
15. お前 【お・まえ】 - you (casual)
16. 金髪 【きん・ぱつ】 - blond hair
17. 女 【おんな】 - woman; girl
18. 好き 【す・き】 (na-adj) - likable; desirable
19. もう - already
20. ～時 【～じ】 - counter for hours
21. なる (u-verb) - to become
22. 来る 【く・る】 (exception) - to come
23. ただ - free of charge; only
24. 試合 【し・あい】 - match, game
25. その - that (abbr. of それの)
26. 人 【ひと】 - person
27. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
28. かわいい (i-adj) - cute
29. かわいそう (i-adj) - pitiable
30. 犬 【いぬ】 - dog

The problem with English is that the expression, "seems like" has too many meanings. It can mean similarity in appearance, similarity in behavior or even that current evidence points to a likely outcome. We will now learn how to say the third meaning: how to indicate a likely outcome given the situation.

Just like the grammar we have learned so far in this lesson, we can use this grammar by simply attaching 「そう」 to the end of verbs, and adjectives. However, there are four important different cases. Actually, I just noticed this but the conjugation rules are exactly the same as the 「～すぎる」 grammar we learned in the last section. The only difference is that for the adjective 「いい」, you need to change it to 「よさ」 before attaching 「そう」 to create 「よさそう」.

Rules for conjugation

1. Verbs must be changed to the *stem*.
2. The 「い」 in i-adjectives must be dropped except for 「いい」.
3. 「いい」 must first be conjugated to 「よさ」.
4. For all negatives, the 「い」 must be replaced with 「さ」.
5. This grammar does not work with plain nouns.

1. Verb must be changed to the stem.

For ru-verbs, remove the 「る」

- バランスが崩れて、一瞬倒れそうだった。
Losing my balance, I seemed likely to fall for a moment.

For u-verbs, change the / u / vowel sound to an / i / vowel sound

- この辺りにありそうだけどな。
It seems likely that it would be around here but...

2. The 「い」 in i-adjectives must be dropped.

In the next example, the 「い」 has been dropped from 「おいしい」.

- この漬物はおいしそう！
I bet this pickled vegetable is tasty! (This pickled vegetable looks good!)

Exception: The only exception to this rule is the adjective 「いい」. When using this grammar with 「いい」, you must first change it to 「よさ」.

- これも結構よさそうだけど、やっぱり高いよね。
This one also seems to be good but, as expected, it's expensive, huh?

Nothing needs to be done for na-adjectives.

- お前なら、金髪の女が好きそうだな。
Knowing you, I bet you like blond-haired girls.

3. For all negatives, the 「い」 must be replaced with 「さ」.

The negative of 「来る」 is 「こない」 so when used with 「～そう」, it becomes 「こなさそう」.

1. もう10時になったから、来なさそうだね。
Since it already became 10:00, it's likely that (person) won't come.
2. これはただの試合じゃなさそうだ。
This isn't likely to be an ordinary match.

Identical to the 「～すぎる」 grammar, i-adjectives that are derived from the negative 「～ない」 like 「もったいない」 or 「情けない」 also follow this rule as well (which would be 「もったいなさそう」 and 「情けなさそう」 in this case).

4. This grammar does not work with plain nouns.

- その人は学生そう。

There are other grammar we have already covered that can be used to indicate that something is likely to be something else.

1. その人は学生でしょう。
That person is probably student.
2. その人は学生だろう。
That person is probably student.

Be careful never to use 「かわいい」 with this grammar. 「かわいそう」 is a completely different word used when you feel sorry for something or someone. 「かわいい」 means, "to look cute" already so you never need to use any of the grammar in this lesson to say something looks cute.

1. この犬はかわいそう。
Oh, this poor dog.
2. この犬はかわいい。
This dog is cute.

Expressing hearsay using 「～そうだ」

Vocabulary

1. 明日【あした】 - tomorrow
2. 雨【あめ】 - rain
3. 降る【ふ・る】 (u-verb) - to precipitate
4. 毎日【まい・にち】 - everyday
5. 会う【あ・う】 (u-verb) - to meet
6. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
7. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
8. 高校生【こう・こう・せい】 - high school student
9. 今日【きょう】 - today
10. 田中【た・なか】 - Tanaka (last name)
11. 来る【く・る】 (exception) - to come

The reason that there are so many annoying rules to using 「～そう」 is to distinguish it from this next grammar we will learn. This is a useful grammar for talking about things you heard that doesn't necessary have anything to do with how you yourself, think or feel. Unlike the last grammar we learned, you can simply attach 「そうだ」 to verbs and i-adjectives. For na-adjectives and nouns, you must indicate the state-of-being by adding 「だ」 to the noun/na-adjective. Also, notice that 「そう」 itself must always end in 「だ」、「です」、or 「でございます」. These differences are what distinguishes this grammar from the one we learned in the last section. There are no tenses for this grammar.

1. 明日、雨が降るそうだ。
I hear that it's going to rain tomorrow.
2. 毎日会いに行ったそうです。
I heard he went to meet everyday.

Don't forget to add 「だ」 for nouns or na-adjectives.

- 彼は、高校生だそうです。
I hear that he is a high school student.

When starting the sentence with this grammar, you also need to add 「だ」 just like you do with 「だから」

A : 今日、田中さんはこないの？
A: Is Tanaka-san not coming today?

B : だそうです。
B: So I hear.

Expressing hearsay or behavior using 「～らしい」

Vocabulary

1. 今日【きょう】 - today
2. 田中【た・なか】 - Tanaka (last name)
3. 来る【く・る】 (exception) - to come
4. あの - that (over there) (abbr. of あれの)
5. 人【ひと】 - person
6. 何【なん】 - what
7. 美由紀【み・ゆ・き】 - Miyuki (first name)
8. 友達【とも・だち】 - friend
9. 子【こ】 - child
10. 子供【こ・ども】 - child
11. 大人【おとな】 - adult
12. する (exception) - to do
13. つもり - intention, plan
14. 大騒ぎ【おお・さわ・ぎ】 - big commotion

「らしい」 can be directly attached to nouns, adjectives, or verbs to show that things appear to be a certain way due to what you've heard. This is different from 「～そうだ」 because 「～そうだ」 indicates something you heard about specifically while 「らしい」 means things seem to be a certain way based on some things you heard about the subject. 「らしい」 conjugates like a normal i-adjective.

Example 1

A : 今日、田中さんはこないの？

A: Is Tanaka-san not coming today?

B : こないらしい。

B: Seems like it (based on what I heard).

Example 2

A : あの人は何なの？

A: What is that person over there?

B : 美由紀さんの友達らしいですよ。

B: Seems to be Miyuki-san's friend (based on what I heard).

Another way to use 「らしい」 is to indicate that a person seems to be a certain thing due to his behavior.

1. あの子は子供らしくない。

That child does not act like a child.

2. 大人らしくするつもりだったのに、大騒ぎしてしまった。

Despite the fact that I planned to act like an adult, I ended up making a big ruckus.

「っぽい」 : Slang expression of similarity

Vocabulary

1. あの - that (over there) (abbr. of あれの)
2. 人 【ひと】 - person
3. 韓国人 【かん・こく・じん】 - Korean person
4. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
5. もう - already
6. 全部 【ぜん・ぶ】 - everything
7. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
8. 恭子 【きょう・こ】 - Kyouko (first name)
9. 全然 【ぜん・ぜん】 - not at all (when used with negative)
10. 女 【おんな】 - woman; girl

A really casual way to express similarity is to attach 「っぽい」 to the word that reflects the resemblance. Because this is a very casual expression, you can use it as a casual version for all the different types of expression for similarity covered above.

「っぽい」 conjugates just like an i-adjective, as seen by example 3 below.

1. あの人はちょっと韓国人っぽいよね。
That person looks a little like Korean person, huh?
2. みんなで、もう全部食べてしまったっぽいよ。
It appears that everybody ate everything already.
3. 恭子は全然女っぽくないね。
Kyouko is not womanly at all, huh?

Using 「方」 and 「よる」

If you were wondering how to make comparison in Japanese, well wonder no more. We will learn how to use 「方」 and 「より」 to make comparisons between two things. We will also learn other uses of 「方」 and 「よる」 along the way.

Using 「方」 for comparisons

Vocabulary

1. 方 【1) ほう; 2) かた】 - 1) direction; side; 2) person; way of doing
2. ご飯 【ご・はん】 - rice; meal
3. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
4. 鈴木 【すず・き】 - Suzuki (last name)
5. 若い 【わか・い】 (i-adj) - young
6. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student
7. いい (i-adj) - good
8. 赤ちゃん 【あか・ちゃん】 - baby
9. 静か 【しず・か】 (na-adj) - quiet
10. 好き 【す・き】 (na-adj) - likable; desirable
11. ゆっくり - slowly
12. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
13. 健康 【けん・こう】 - health
14. こちら - this way
15. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
16. 早い 【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
17. 怖い 【こわ・い】 (i-adj) - scary
18. 映画 【えい・が】 - movie
19. 観る 【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to watch
20. そんな - that sort of
21. 飲む 【の・む】 (u-verb) - to drink

The noun 「方」 is read as 「ほう」 when it is used to mean a direction or orientation. As an aside, it can also be read as 「かた」 when it is used as a politer version of 「人」.

When we use 「方」 to mean direction, we can use it for comparison by saying one way of things is better, worse, etc., than the other way. Grammatically, it works just like any other regular nouns.

Examples

Use it with nouns by utilizing the 「の」 particle.

1. ご飯の方がおいしい
Rice is tastier. (lit: The way of rice is tasty.)
2. 鈴木さんの方が若い。
Suzuki-san is younger. (lit: The way of Suzuki is young.)

Grammatically, it's no different from a regular noun.

1. 学生じゃない方がいいよ。
It's better to not be a student. (lit: The way of not being student is good.)

2. 赤ちゃんは、静かな方が好き。

Like quiet babies more. (lit: About babies, the quiet way is desirable.)

For non-negative verbs, you can also use the past tense to add more certainty and confidence, particularly when making suggestions.

1. ゆっくり食べた方が健康にいいよ。

It's better for your health to eat slowly.

2. こちらから行った方が早かった。

It was faster to go from this way.

The same thing does not apply for negative verbs.

- 怖い映画は観ない方がいいよ。

It's better not to watch scary movie(s).

The negative verb is only in the past tense when the comparison is of something that happened in the past.

- そんなに飲まなかった方がよかった。

It was better not to have drunk that much.

Using 「より」 for comparisons

Vocabulary

1. 方【(1) ほう; 2) かた】 - 1) direction; side; 2) person; way of doing
2. 花【はな】 - flower
3. 団子【だん・ご】 - dango (dumpling)
4. ご飯【ご・はん】 - rice; meal
5. パン - bread
6. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
7. 若い【わか・い】 (i-adj) - young
8. 鈴木【すず・き】 - Suzuki (last name)
9. 毎日【まい・にち】 - everyday
10. 仕事【し・ごと】 - job
11. 嫌【いや】 (na-adj) disagreeable; unpleasant
12. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
13. まし - not as bad
14. ゆっくり - slowly
15. 食べる【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
16. 早い【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
17. いい (i-adj) - good

You can think of 「より」 as being the opposite of 「方」. It means, "rather than" or "as opposed to". It attaches directly to the back of any word. It is usually used in conjunction with 「方」 to say something like, "This way is better as opposed to that way."

Examples

1. 花より団子。
Dango rather than flowers. (This is a very famous saying.)
2. ご飯の方が、パンよりおいしい。
Rice tastes better than bread. (lit: The rice way is tasty as opposed to bread.)
3. キムさんより鈴木さんの方が若い。
Suzuki-san is younger than Kim-san. (lit: The way of Suzuki is young as opposed to Kim-san.)

For those curious about the meaning of the proverb, dango is a sweet doughy treat usually sold at festivals. The proverb is saying that people prefer this treat to watching the flowers, referring to the 「花見」 event where people go out to see the cherry blossoms (and get smashed). The deeper meaning of the proverb, like all good proverbs, depends on how you apply it.

Of course, there is no rule that 「より」 must be used with 「方」. The other way of things can be gleaned from context.

鈴木：毎日仕事に行くのが嫌だ。
Suzuki: I don't like going to work everyday.

スミス：仕事がないよりましだよ。

Smith: It's not as bad as opposed to not having a job.

Words associated with 「より」 do not need any tense. Notice in the following sentence that 「食べる」 in front of 「より」 is present tense even though 「食べる」 in front of 「方」 is past tense.

- ゆっくり食べた方が早く食べるよりいい。

It is better to eat slowly as opposed to eating quickly.

Using 「より」 as a superlative

Vocabulary

1. 誰【だれ】 - who
2. 何【なに】 - what
3. どこ - where
4. 商品【しょう・ひん】 - product
5. 品質【ひん・しつ】 - quality of a good
6. 大切【たい・せつ】 (na-adj) - important
7. する (exception) - to do
8. この - this (abbr. of これの)
9. 仕事【し・ごと】 - job
10. 早い【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
11. 出来る【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do

You can also use 「より」 with question words such as 「誰」、「何」、or 「どこ」 to make a superlative by comparing with everything or everybody else. In this case, though not required, it is common to include the 「も」 particle.

Examples

1. 商品の品質を何より大切にしています。
We place value in product's quality over anything else.
2. この仕事は誰よりも早くできます。
Can do this job more quickly than anyone else.

Using 「方」 to express a way to do something

Vocabulary

1. 方 【1) ほう; 2) かた】 - 1) direction; side; 2) person; way of doing
2. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
3. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
4. 新宿 【しん・じゅく】 - Shinjuku
5. 分かる 【わ・かる】 (u-verb) - to understand
6. そう - (things are) that way
7. 言う 【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
8. 体 【からだ】 - body
9. いい (i-adj) - good
10. 漢字 【かん・じ】 - Kanji
11. 書く 【か・く】 (u-verb) - to write
12. 教える 【おし・える】 (ru-verb) - to teach; to inform
13. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
14. パソコン - computer, PC
15. 使う 【つか・う】 (u-verb) - to use
16. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
17. 知る 【し・る】 (u-verb) - to know

You can also attach 「方」 to the stem of verbs to express a way to do that verb. In this usage, 「方」 is read as 「かた」 and the result becomes a noun. For example, 「行き方」 (いきかた) means, "the way to go" or 「食べ方」 (たべかた) means, "the way to eat". This expression is probably what you want to use when you want to ask how to do something.

Examples

1. 新宿の行き方はわかりますか。
Do you know the way to go to Shinjuku?
2. そういう食べ方は体によくないよ。
Eating in that way is not good for your body.
3. 漢字の書き方を教えてくださいませんか？
Can you teach me the way of writing kanji?
4. パソコンの使い方は、みんな知っているでしょう。
Probably everybody knows the way to use PC's.

When verbs are transformed to this form, the result becomes a noun clause. Sometimes, this requires a change of particles. For instance, while 「行く」 usually involves a target (the 「に」 or 「へ」 particle), since 「行き方」 is a noun clause, example 1 becomes 「新宿の行き方」 instead of the familiar 「新宿に行く」.

Using 「によって」 to express dependency

Vocabulary

1. 人【ひと】 - person
2. 話【はなし】 - story
3. 違う【ちが・う】 (u-verb) - to be different
4. 季節【き・せつ】 - season
5. 果物【くだ・もの】 - fruit
6. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
7. なる (u-verb) - to become
8. まずい (i-adj) - unpleasant
9. 和子【かず・こ】 - Kazuko (first name)
10. 今日【きょう】 - today
11. 飲む【の・む】 (u-verb) - to drink
12. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
13. 大樹【だい・き】 - Daiki (first name)
14. それ - that
15. 裕子【ゆう・こ】 - Yuuko (first name)

When you want to say, "depending on [X]", you can do this in Japanese by simply attaching 「によって」 to [X].

Examples

1. 人によって話が違う。
The story is different depending on the person.
2. 季節によって果物はおいしくなったり、まずくなったりする。
Fruit becomes tasty or nasty depending on the season.

This is simply the te-form of 「よる」 as seen by the following simple exchange.

和子：今日は飲みに行こうか？
Kazuko: Shall we go drinking today?

大樹：それは、裕子によるね。
Daiki: That depends on Yuuko.

Indicating a source of information using 「によると」

Vocabulary

1. 天気【てん・き】 - weather
2. 予報【よ・ほう】 - forecast
3. 今日【きょう】 - today
4. 雨【あめ】 - rain
5. 友達【とも・だち】 - friend
6. 話【はなし】 - story
7. 朋子【とも・こ】 - Tomoko (first name)
8. やっと - finally
9. ボーイフレンド - boyfriend
10. 見つける【み・つける】 (ru-verb) - to find

Another expression using 「よる」 is by using it with the target and the decided conditional 「と」 to indicate a source of information. In English, this would translate to "according to [X]" where 「によると」 is attached to [X].

Examples

1. 天気予報によると、今日は雨だそうだ。
According to the weather forecast, I hear today is rain.
2. 友達の話によると、朋子はやっとボーイフレンドを見つけたらしい。
According to a friend's story, it appears that Tomoko finally found a boyfriend.

Actions that are easy or hard to do

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. しゃべる (u-verb) - to talk
3. この - this (abbr. of これの)
4. 字 【じ】 - character; hand-writing
5. 読む 【よ・ む】 (u-verb) - to read
6. カクテル - cocktail
7. ビール - beer
8. 飲む 【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink
9. 部屋 【へ・ や】 - room
10. 暗い 【くら・ い】 (i-adj) - dark
11. 見る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to see
12. 難しい 【むずか・ しい】 (i-adj) - difficult
13. 易しい 【やさ・ しい】 (i-adj) - easy
14. 簡単 【かん・ たん】 (na-adj) - simple
15. 容易 【よう・ い】 (na-adj) - simple
16. その - that (abbr. of それの)
17. 肉 【にく】 - meat

This is a short easy lesson on how to transform verbs into adjectives describing whether that action is easy or difficult to do. Basically, it consists of changing the verb into the stem and adding 「やすい」 for easy and 「にくい」 for hard. The result then becomes a regular i-adjective. Pretty easy, huh?

Using 「～やすい、～にくい」 to describe easy and difficult actions

To describe an action as being easy, change the verb to the stem and add 「やすい」. To describe an action as being difficult, attach 「にくい」 to the stem.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べやすい
2. しゃべる → しゃべり → しゃべりにくい

The result becomes a regular i-adjective.

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	食べに <u>くい</u>	食べにく <u>くない</u>
Past	食べにく <u>かった</u>	食べにく <u>くなかった</u>

Examples

1. この字は読みにくい。
This hand-writing is hard to read.
2. カクテルはビールより飲みやすい。
Cocktails are easier to drink than beer.
3. 部屋が暗かったので、見にくかった。
Since the room was dark, it was hard to see.

As an aside: Be careful with 「見にくい」 because 「醜い」 is a rarely used adjective meaning, "ugly". I wonder if it's just coincidence that "difficult to see" and "ugly" sound exactly the same?

Of course, you can always use some other grammatical structure that we have already learned to express the same thing using appropriate adjectives such as 「難しい」、「易しい」、「簡単」、「容易」、etc. The following two sentences are essentially identical in meaning.

1. その肉は食べにくい。
That meat is hard to eat.
2. その肉を食べるのは難しい。
The thing of eating that meat is difficult.

Variations of 「～にくい」 with 「～がたい」 and 「～づらい」

Vocabulary

1. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
2. 忘れる【わす・れる】 (ru-verb) - to forget
3. 思い出【おも・い・で】 - memories
4. 大切【たい・せつ】 (na-adj) - important
5. する (exception) - to do
6. とても - very
7. 信じる【しん・じる】 (ru-verb) - to believe
8. 話【はなし】 - story
9. 本当【ほん・とう】 - real
10. 起こる【おこ・る】 (u-verb) - to happen
11. 辛い【1) から・い; 2) つら・い】 (i-adj) - 1) spicy; 2) painful
12. 日本語【に・ほん・ご】 - Japanese (language)
13. 読む【よ・む】 (u-verb) - to read
14. 待ち合わせ【ま・ち・あわ・せ】 - meeting arrangement
15. 分かる【わ・かる】 (u-verb) - to understand
16. 場所【ば・しょ】 - location

The kanji for 「にくい」 actually comes from 「難い」 which can also be read as 「かたい」. As a result, you can also add a voiced version 「～がたい」 as a verb suffix to express the same thing as 「にくい」. 「にくい」 is more common for speaking while 「がたい」 is more suited for the written medium. 「にくい」 tends to be used for physical actions while 「がたい」 is usually reserved for less physical actions that don't actually require movement. However, there seems to be no hard rule on which is more appropriate for a given verb so I suggest searching for both versions in google to ascertain the popularity of a given combination. You should also always write the suffix in hiragana to prevent ambiguities in the reading.

Examples

1. 彼との忘れがたい思い出を大切にしている。
I am treating importantly the hard to forget memories of and with him.
2. とても信じがたい話だが、本当に起こったらしい。
It's a very difficult to believe story but it seems (from hearsay) that it really happened.

Yet another, more coarse variation of stem + 「にくい」 is to use 「づらい」 instead which is a slightly transformed version of 「辛い」 (つらい). This is not to be confused with the same 「辛い」 (からい), which means spicy!

Examples

1. 日本語は読みづらいな。

Man, Japanese is hard to read.

2. 待ち合わせは、分かりづらい場所にしないでね。

Please don't pick a difficult to understand location for the meeting arrangement.

More negative verbs

We already learned the most common type of negative verbs; the ones that end in 「ない」 . However, there are couple more different types of negatives verbs. The ones you will find most useful are the first two, which expresses an action that was done without having done another action. The others are fairly obscure or useful only for very casual expressions. However, you *will* run into them if you learn Japanese for a fair amount of time.

Doing something without doing something else

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. 寝る 【ね・ る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
3. 何 【なに / なん】 - what
4. 歯 【は】 - tooth
5. 磨く 【みが・ く】 (u-verb) - to brush; to polish
6. 学校 【がっ・ こう】 - school
7. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
8. 宿題 【しゅく・ だい】 - homework
9. する (exception) - to do
10. 授業 【じゅ・ ぎょう】 - class
11. 止める 【や・ める】 (ru-verb) - to stop
12. 方 【1) ほう; 2) かた】 - 1) direction; side; 2) person; way of doing
13. いい (i-adj) - good
14. 先生 【せん・ せい】 - teacher
15. 相談 【そう・ だん】 - consultation
16. この - this (abbr. of これの)
17. 取る 【と・ る】 (u-verb) - to take
18. こと - event, matter
19. 出来る 【で・ き・ る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
20. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
21. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
22. 帰る 【かえ・ る】 (u-verb) - to go home
23. そんな - that sort of
24. お酒 【お・ さけ】 - alcohol
25. 飲む 【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink
26. 当然 【とう・ ぜん】 - naturally
27. 酔っ払う 【よ・ っ・ ぱ・ らう】 (u-verb) - to get drunk
28. 勉強 【べん・ きょう】 - study
29. 東大 【とう・ だい】 - Tokyo University (abbr. for 「東京大学」)
30. 入る 【はい・ る】 (u-verb) - to enter
31. 思う 【おも・ う】 (u-verb) - to think

Way back when, we learned how to express a sequence of actions and this worked fine for both positive and negative verbs. For instance, the sentence "I didn't eat, and then I went to sleep" would become 「食べなくて寝た。」 However, this sentence sounds a bit strange because eating doesn't have much to do with sleeping. What we probably *really* want to say is that we went to sleep *without* eating. To express this, we need to use a more generalized form of the negative request we covered at the very end of the giving and receiving lesson. In other words, instead of substituting the last 「い」 with 「くて」, we need only append 「で」 instead.

Doing something without doing something else

To indicate an action that was done *without* doing another action, add 「で」 to the negative of the action that was not done.

Example

食べる → 食べない → 食べないで

Examples

1. 何も食べないで寝ました。
Went to sleep without eating anything.
2. 歯を磨かないで、学校に行っちゃいました。
Went to school without brushing teeth (by accident).
3. 宿題をしないで、授業に行くのは、やめた方がいいよ。
It's better to stop going to class without doing homework.
4. 先生と相談しないで、この授業を取ることは出来ない。
You cannot take this class without consulting with teacher.

Hopefully not too difficult. Another way to express the exact same thing is to replace the last 「ない」 part with 「ず」. However, the two exception verbs 「する」 and 「くる」 become 「せず」 and 「こず」 respectively. It is also common to see this grammar combined with the target 「に」 particle. This version is more formal than 「ないで」 and is not used as much in regular conversations.

Doing something without doing something else

- Another way to indicate an action that was done without doing another action is to replace the 「ない」 part of the negative action that was not done with 「ず」.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べない → 食べず
2. 行く → 行かない → 行かず

- Exceptions:

1. する → せず
2. くる → こず

Examples

1. 彼は何も言わず、帰ってしまった。

He went home without saying anything.

2. 何も食べずにそんなにお酒を飲むと当然酔っ払いますよ。

Obviously, you're going to get drunk if you drink that much without eating anything.

3. 勉強せずに東大に入れると思わないな。

I don't think you can get in Tokyo University without studying.

A casual masculine type of negative that ends in 「ん」

Vocabulary

1. する (exception) - to do
2. 来る 【く・る】 (exception) - to come
3. すまん - sorry (masculine)
4. すみません - sorry (polite)
5. 知る 【し・る】 (u-verb) - to know
6. 韓国人 【かん・こく・じん】 - Korean person
7. 結婚 【けっ・こん】 - marriage
8. なる (u-verb) - to become
9. そんな - that sort of
10. こと - event, matter
11. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
12. 今日 【きょう】 - today
13. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go

Finally, we cover another type of negative that is used mostly by older men. Since 「ない」 is so long and difficult to say (sarcasm), you can shorten it to just 「ん」. However, you can't directly modify other words in this form; in other words, you can't make it a modifying relative clause. In the same manner as before, 「する」 becomes 「せん」 and 「くる」 becomes 「こん」 though I've never heard or seen 「こん」 actually being used. If you have ever heard 「すまん」 and wondered what that meant, it's actually an example of this grammar. Notice that 「すみません」 is actually in polite negative form. Well, the plain form would be 「すまない」, right? That further transforms to just 「すまん」. The word brings up an image of おじさん but that may be just me. Anyway, it's a male expression.

A shorter way to say negative verbs

- A shorter way to say a negative verb is to use 「ん」 instead of 「ない」.

Example

知る → 知らない → 知らん

- Exceptions:

1. する → せん

2. くる → こん

Examples

1. すまん。

Sorry.

2. 韓国人と結婚しなくてはならん！

You must marry a Korean!

3. そんなことはさせん！

I won't let you do such a thing!

You can even use this slang for past tense verbs by adding 「かった」.

- 皆、今日行くて、知らんかったよ。

I didn't know everybody was going today.

A classical negative verb that ends in 「ぬ」

Vocabulary

1. する (exception) - to do
2. 来る 【く・ る】 (exception) - to come
3. 知る 【し・ る】 (u-verb) - to know
4. 韓国人 【かん・ こく・ じん】 - Korean person
5. 結婚 【けっ・ こん】 - marriage
6. なる (u-verb) - to become
7. 模擬 【も・ ぎ】 - mock
8. 試験 【し・ けん】 - exam
9. 何回 【なん・ かい】 - how many times
10. 失敗 【しっ・ ぱい】 - failure
11. 実際 【じっ・ さい】 - actual
12. 受ける 【う・ ける】 (ru-verb) - to receive
13. 思う 【おも・ う】 (u-verb) - to think
14. 結果 【けっ・ か】 - result
15. 出る 【で・ る】 (ru-verb) - to come out

There is yet another version of the negative verb conjugation and it uses 「ぬ」 instead of the 「ない」 that attaches to the end of the verb. While this version of the negative conjugation is old-fashioned and part of classical Japanese, you will still encounter it occasionally. In fact, I just saw this conjugation on a sign at the train station today, so it's not too uncommon.

For any verb, you can replace 「ない」 with 「ぬ」 to get to an old-fashion sounding version of the negative. Similar to the last section, 「する」 becomes 「せぬ」 and 「くる」 becomes 「こぬ」. You may hear this grammar being used from older people or your friends if they want to bring back ye olde days.

An old-fashioned way to say negative verbs

- An old-fashioned way to say a negative verb is to use 「ぬ」 instead of 「ない」.

Example

知る → 知らない → 知らぬ

- Exceptions:

1. する → せぬ

2. くる → こぬ

Examples

1. 韓国人と結婚してはならぬ！

You must not marry a Korean!

2. 模擬試験に何回も失敗して、実際に受けてみたら思わぬ結果が出た。

After having failed mock examination any number of times, a result I wouldn't have thought came out when I actually tried taking the test.

Hypothesizing and Concluding

In this section, we're going to learn how to make hypotheses and reach conclusions using: 「と
する」 and 「わけ」 (訳) .

Coming to a conclusion with 「わけ」

Vocabulary

1. 訳 【わけ】 - meaning; reason; can be deduced
2. 直子 【なお・ こ】 - Naoko (first name)
3. いくら - how much
4. 英語 【えい・ ご】 - English (language)
5. 勉強 【べん・ きょう】 - study
6. する (exception) - to do
7. うまい (i-adj) - skillful; delicious
8. なる (u-verb) - to become
9. つまり - in short
10. 語学 【ご・ がく】 - language study
11. 能力 【のう・ りょく】 - ability
12. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
13. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
14. 失礼 【しつ・ れい】 - discourtesy
15. 中国語 【ちゅう・ ごく・ ご】 - Chinese language
16. 読む 【よ・ む】 (u-verb) - to read
17. 広子 【ひろ・ こ】 - Hiroko (first name)
18. 家 【1) うち; 2) いえ】 - 1) one's own home; 2) house
19. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
20. こと - event, matter
21. 一郎 【いち・ ろう】 - Ichirou (first name)
22. 微積分 【び・ せき・ ぶん】 - (differential and integral) calculus
23. 分かる 【わ・ かる】 (u-verb) - to understand
24. ここ - here
25. 試験 【し・ けん】 - exam
26. 合格 【ごう・ かく】 - pass (as in an exam)
27. 今度 【こん・ ど】 - this time; another time
28. 負ける 【ま・ ける】 (ru-verb) - to lose
29. 来る 【く・ る】 (exception) - to come
30. あきらめる (ru-verb) - to give up

The noun 「わけ」 (訳) is a bit difficult to describe but it's defined as: "meaning; reason; can be deduced". You can see how this word is used in the following mini-dialogue.

Example 1

直子：いくら英語を勉強しても、うまくならないの。

Naoko: No matter how much I study, I don't become better at English.

ジム：つまり、語学には、能力がないという訳か。

Jim: So basically, it means that you don't have ability at language.

直子：失礼ね。
Naoko: How rude.

As you can see, Jim is concluding from what Naoko said that she must not have any skills at learning languages. This is completely different from the explanatory 「の」, which is used to explain something that may or may not be obvious. 「わけ」 is instead used to draw conclusions that anyone might be able to arrive at given certain information.

A very useful application of this grammar is to combine it with 「ない」 to indicate that there is no reasonable conclusion. This allows some very useful expression like, "How in the world am I supposed to know that?"

- 中国語が読めるわけがない。

There's no way I can read Chinese. (lit: There is no reasoning for [me] to be able to read Chinese.)

Under the normal rules of grammar, we must have a particle for the noun 「わけ」 in order to use it with the verb but since this type of expression is used so often, the particle is often dropped to create just 「～わけない」.

Example 2

直子：広子の家に行ったことある？
Naoko: Have you ever gone to Hiroko's house?

一郎：あるわけないでしょう。
Ichirou: There's no way I would have ever gone to her house, right?

Example 3

直子：微積分は分かる？
Naoko: Do you understand (differential and integral) calculus?

一郎：分かるわけないよ！
Ichirou: There's no way I would understand!

There is one thing to be careful of because 「わけない」 can also mean that something is very easy (lit: requires no explanation). You can easily tell when this meaning is intended however, because it is used in the same manner as an adjective.

- この試験に合格するのはわけない。

It's easy to pass the tests here.

Finally, although not as common, 「わけ」 can also be used as a formal expression for saying that something must or must not be done at all costs. This is simply a stronger and more formal version of 「～てはいけない」. This grammar is created by simply attaching 「わけにはいかない」. The

「は」 is the topic particle and is pronounced 「わ」 . The reason 「いけない」 changes to 「い
かない」 is probably related to intransitive and transitive verbs but I don't want to get too caught up
in the logistics of it. Just take note that it's 「いかない」 in this case and not 「いけない」 .

1. 今度は負けるわけにはいかない。
This time, I must not lose at all costs.
2. ここまで来て、あきらめるわけにはいかない。
After coming this far, I must not give up.

Making hypotheses with 「とする」

Vocabulary

1. する (exception) - to do
2. 明日 【あした】 - tomorrow
3. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
4. 今 【いま】 - now
5. ～時 【～じ】 - counter for hours
6. 着く 【つ・く】 (u-verb) - to arrive
7. 思う 【おも・う】 (u-verb) - to think
8. 観客 【かん・きゃく】 - spectator
9. 参加 【さん・か】 - participation
10. もらう - to receive
11. 被害者 【ひ・がい・しゃ】 - victim
12. 非常 【ひ・じょう】 - extreme
13. 幸い 【さいわ・い】 (na-adj) - fortunate
14. 朝ご飯 【あさ・ご・はん】 - breakfast
15. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
16. もう - already
17. 昼 【ひる】 - afternoon
18. お腹 【お・なか】 - stomach
19. 空く 【す・く】 (u-verb) - to become empty

While this next grammar doesn't necessarily have anything directly related to the previous grammar, I thought it would fit nicely together. In a previous lesson, we learn how to combine the volitional form with 「とする」 to indicate an attempt to perform an action. We will now learn several other ways 「とする」 can be used. It may help to keep in mind that 「とする」 is really just a combination of the quotation particle 「と」 and the verb 「する」 meaning "to do". Let's say you have a sentence: [verb]とする. This means literally that you are doing like "[verb]" (in quotes). As you can see, when used with the volitional, it becomes: "Doing like making motion to do [verb]". In other words, you are acting as if to make a motion to do [verb]. As we have already seen, this translates to "attempt to do [verb]". Let's see what happens when we use it on plain verbs.

Examples

- 明日に行く とする。

Assume we go tomorrow.

The example above is considering what would happen supposing that they should decide to go tomorrow. You can see that the literal translation "do like we go tomorrow" still makes sense. However, in this situation, we are making a hypothesis unlike the grammar we have gone over before with the volitional form of the verb. Since we are considering a hypothesis, it is reasonable to assume that the conditional will be very handy here and indeed, you will often see sentences like the following:

- 今から行くとしたら、9時に着くと思います。

If we suppose that we go from now, I think we will arrive at 9:00.

As you can see, the verb 「する」 has been conjugated to the 「たら」 conditional form to consider what would happen *if* you assume a certain case. You can also change 「する」 to the te-form (して) and use it as a sequence of actions like so:

1. 観客として参加させてもらった。

Received favor of allowing to participate as spectator.

2. 被害者としては、非常に幸いだった。

As a victim, was extremely fortunate.

3. 朝ご飯を食べたとしても、もう昼だからお腹が空いたでしょう。

Even assuming that you ate breakfast, because it's already noon, you're probably hungry, right?

The same idea applies here as well. In example 1, you are doing like a "spectator" and doing like a "victim" in example 2 and finally, doing like you ate breakfast in example 3. So you can see why the same grammar applies for all these types of sentences because they all mean the same thing in Japanese (minus the use of additional particles and various conjugations of 「する」).

Time-specific actions

In this lesson, we will go over various ways to express actions that take place in a certain time-frame. In particular, we will learn how to say: 1) an action has just been completed, 2) an action is taken immediately after another action took place, 3) an action occurs while another action is ongoing, and 4) one continuously repeats an action.

Expressing what just happened with 「～ばかり」

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【たべ・る】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. すみません - sorry (polite)
3. 今 【いま】 - now
4. お腹 【お・なか】 - stomach
5. いっぱい - full
6. キロ - kilo
7. 走る 【はし・る】 (u-verb) - to run
8. 凄い 【すご・い】 (i-adj) - to a great extent
9. 疲れる 【つか・れる】 (ru-verb) - to get tired
10. 家 【1) うち; 2) いえ】 - 1) one's own home; 2) house
11. 帰る 【かえ・る】 (u-verb) - to go home
12. 昼ご飯 【ひる・ご・はん】 - lunch
13. もう - already
14. 空く 【す・く】 (u-verb) - to become empty
15. まさか - no way, you can't mean to say
16. 起きる 【お・きる】 (ru-verb) - to wake; to occur

This is a very useful grammar that is used to indicate that one has just finished doing something. For instance, the first time I really wished I knew how to say something like this was when I wanted to politely decline an invitation to eat because I had just eaten. To do this, take the past tense of verb that you want to indicate as just being completed and add 「ばかり」. This is used with only the past tense of verbs and is not to be confused with the 「ばかり」 used with nouns to express amounts.

Just like the other type of 「ばかり」 we have covered before, in slang, you can hear people use 「ばっか」 instead of 「ばかり」.

Using 「ばかり」 for actions just completed

- To indicate that an action has ended just recently, take the past tense of the verb and add 「ばかり」. Example: 食べる → 食べた → 食べたばかり
- For casual speech, you can abbreviate 「ばかり」 to just 「ばっか」. Example: 食べたばかり → 食べたばっか

You can treat the result as you would with any noun.

Positive		Negative	
食べたばかり (だ)	Just ate	食べたばかりじゃない	Didn't just eat

Examples

1. すみません、今食べたばかりなので、お腹がいっぱいです。 Sorry, but I'm full having just eaten.
2. 10キロを走ったばかりで、凄く疲れた。 I just ran 10 kilometers and am really tired.
3. 今、家に帰ったばかりです。 I got back home just now.

Here are some examples of the abbreviated version.

1. 昼ご飯を食べたばっかなのに、もうお腹が空いた。 Despite the fact that I just ate lunch, I'm hungry already.
2. まさか、今起きたばっかなの？ No way, did you wake up just now?

Express what occurred immediately after with 「とたん」

Vocabulary

1. 開ける 【あ・ ける】 (ru-verb) - to open
2. 取る 【と・ る】 (u-verb) - to take
3. 窓 【まど】 - window
4. 猫 【ねこ】 - cat
5. 跳ぶ 【と・ ぶ】 (u-verb) - to jump
6. 映画 【えい・ が】 - movie
7. 観る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to watch
8. トイレ - bathroom; toilet
9. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
10. 眠い 【ねむ・ い】 (i-adj) - sleepy
11. なる (u-verb) - to become

Kind of as a supplement to 「ばかり」, we will cover one way to say something happened as soon as something else occurs. To use this grammar, add 「とたん」 to the past tense of the first action that happened. It is also common to add the 「に」 target particle to indicate that specific point in time.

Using 「とたん」 to describe what happened immediately after

Change the verb that happened first to the *past tense* and attach 「とたん」 or 「とたんに」. Examples

1. 開ける → 開けた → 開けたとたん(に)
2. 取る → 取った → 取ったとたん(に)

⚠Note: You can only use this grammar for things that happen outside your control.

Examples

1. 窓を開けたとたんに、猫が跳んでいった。 As soon as I opened window, cat jumped out.

For many more examples, check these [examples sentences](#) from our old trusty WWWJDIC.

An important thing to realize is that you can only use this grammar for things that occur immediately after something else and not for an action that you, yourself carry out. For instance, compare the following two sentences.

- 映画を観たとたんに、~~トイレに行きました~~。 (You carried out the action of going to the bathroom so this is not correct.)

- 映画を観たとたんに、眠くなりました。(Since becoming sleepy is something that happened outside your control, this sentence is ok.)

Using 「ながら」 for two concurrent actions

Vocabulary

1. 走る【はし・る】(u-verb) - to run
2. テレビ - TV, television
3. 観る【み・る】(ru-verb) - to watch
4. 宿題【しゅく・だい】 - homework
5. する (exception) - to do
6. 音楽【おん・がく】 - music
7. 聴く【き・く】(u-verb) - to listen (e.g. to music);
8. 学校【がっ・こう】 - school
9. 歩く【ある・く】(u-verb) - to walk
10. 好き【す・き】(na-adj) - likable
11. 相手【あい・て】 - other party
12. 何【なに / なん】 - what
13. 言う【い・う】(u-verb) - to say
14. 自分【じ・ぶん】 - oneself
15. 気持ち【き・も・ち】 - feeling
16. 分かる【わ・かる】(u-verb) - to understand
17. 欲しい【ほ・しい】(i-adj) - desirable
18. 単なる【たん・なる】 - simply
19. わがまま (na-adj) - selfish
20. 思う【おも・う】(u-verb) - to think
21. ポップコーン - popcorn
22. 食べる【た・べる】(ru-verb) - to eat
23. 映画【えい・が】 - movie
24. 口笛【くち・ぶえ】 - whistle
25. 手紙【て・がみ】 - letter
26. 書く【か・く】(u-verb) - to write

You can use 「ながら」 to express that one action is taking place in conjunction with another action. To use 「ながら」, you must change the first verb to the stem and append 「ながら」. Though probably rare, you can also attach 「ながら」 to the negative of the verb to express the negative. This grammar has no tense since it is determined by the second verb.

Using 「ながら」 for concurrent actions

- Change the first verb to the *stem* and append 「ながら」 Example 走る → 走り → 走りながら
- For the negative, attach 「ながら」 Example 走る → 走らない → 走らないながら

Examples

1. テレビを観ながら、宿題をする。 Do homework while watching TV.
2. 音楽を聴きながら、学校へ歩くのが好き。 Like to walk to school while listening to music.
3. 相手に何も言わないながら、自分の気持ちをわかってほしいのは単なるわがままだと思わない？ Don't you think that wanting the other person to understand one's feelings while not saying anything is just simply selfishness?

Notice that the sentence ends with the main verb just like it always does. This means that the main action of the sentence is the verb that ends the clause. The 「ながら」 simply describes another action that is also taking place. For example, if we switched the verbs in the first example to say, 「宿題をしながら、テレビを観る。」, this changes the sentence to say, "Watch TV while doing homework." In other words, the main action, in this case, becomes watching TV and the action of doing homework is describing an action that is taking place at the same time.

The tense is controlled by the main verb so the verb used with 「ながら」 cannot have a tense.

1. ポップコーンを食べながら、映画を観る。 Watch movie while eating popcorn.
2. ポップコーンを食べながら、映画を観た。 Watched movie while eating popcorn.
3. 口笛をしながら、手紙を書いていた。 Was writing letter while whistling.

Using 「ながら」 with state-of-being

Vocabulary

1. 残念 【ざん・ねん】 (na-adj) - unfortunate
2. 貧乏 【びん・ぼう】 (na-adj) - poor
3. 仕事 【し・ごと】 - job
4. いっぱい - full
5. 入る 【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter
6. 今日 【きょう】 - today
7. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
8. なる (u-verb) - to become
9. 高級 【こう・きゅう】 (na-adj) - high class, high grade
10. バッグ - bag
11. 買う 【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
12. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
13. 初心者 【しょ・しん・しゃ】 - beginner
14. 実力 【じつ・りょく】 - actual ability
15. プロ - pro
16. 同じ 【おな・じ】 - same

A more advanced use of 「ながら」 is to use it with the implied state-of-being. In other words, you can use it with nouns or adjectives to talk about what something is while something else. The implied state-of-being means that you must not use the declarative 「だ」, you just attach 「ながら」 to the noun or adjective. For example, a common way this grammar is used is to say, "While it's unfortunate, something something..." In Japanese, this would become 「残念ながら・・・」 You can also attach the inclusive 「も」 particle to 「ながら」 to get 「ながらも」. This changes the meaning from "while" to "even while".

Using 「ながら」 or 「ながらも」 with state-of-being

- To say [X] is something while something else, attach 「ながら」 to [X] Example 残念 → 残念ながら
- To say [X] is something even while something else, attach 「ながらも」 to [X] Example 貧乏 → 貧乏ながらも

Examples

1. 仕事がいっぱい入って、残念ながら、今日は行けなくなりました。 While it's unfortunate, a lot of work came in and it became so that I can't go today.

2. 貧乏ながらも、高級なバッグを買っちゃったよ。 Even while I'm poor, I ended up buying a high quality bag.
3. 彼は、初心者ながらも、実力はプロと同じだ。 Even while he is a beginner, his actual skills are the same as a pro.

To repeat something with reckless abandon using 「まくる」

Vocabulary

1. やる (u-verb) - to do
2. ゲーム - game
3. はまる (u-verb) - to get hooked
4. 最近【さい・ きん】 - recent; lately
5. パソコン - computer, PC
6. 使う【つか・ う】 (u-verb) - to use
7. アメリカ - America
8. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
9. 時【とき】 - time
10. コーラ - cola
11. 飲む【の・ む】 (u-verb) - to drink

The WWWJDIC very succinctly defines the definition of this verb as a "verb suffix to indicate reckless abandon to the activity". Unfortunately, it doesn't go on to tell you exactly how it's actually used. Actually, there's not much to explain. You take the stem of the verb and simply attach 「まくる」. However, since this is a continuing activity, it is an *enduring state* unless you're going to do it in the future. This is a very casual expression.

Using 「まくる」 for frequent actions

Change the first verb to the *stem* and append 「まくっている」. Example やる → やり
→ やりまくっている

You can use all the normal conjugations you would expect with any other verb.

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	やりまくっている doing all the time	やりまくっていない don't do all the time
Past	やりまくっていた did all the time	やりまくっていなかった didn't do all the time

Examples

1. ゲームにはまっちゃって、最近パソコンを**使いまくっている**よ。 Having gotten hooked by games, I do nothing but use the computer lately.
2. アメリカにいた時はコーラを**飲みまくっていた**。 When I was in the US, I drank coke like

all the time.

Expressing a lack of change

Up until now, we've mostly been talking about things that have happened or changed in the course of events. We will now learn some simple grammar to express a *lack* of change.

Using 「まま」 to express a lack of change

Vocabulary

1. この - this (abbr. of これの)
2. 宜しい 【よろ・しい】 (i-adj) - good (formal)
3. 半分 【はん・ぶん】 - half
4. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
5. 捨てる 【す・てる】 (ru-verb) - to throw away
6. 駄目 【だめ】 - no good
7. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
8. 今日 【きょう】 - today
9. 悲しい 【かな・しい】 (i-adj) - sad
10. その - that (abbr. of それの)
11. 格好 【かつ・こう】 - appearance
12. クラブ - club; nightclub
13. 入る 【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter

「まま」, not to be confused with the childish expression for "mother" (ママ), is a grammatical phrase to express a lack of change in something. Grammatically, it is used just like a regular noun. You'll most likely hear this grammar at a convenience store when you buy a very small item. Since store clerks use super polite expressions and at lightning fast speeds, learning this one expression will help you out a bit in advance. (Of course, upon showing a lack of comprehension, the person usually repeats the exact same phrase... at the exact same speed.)

Examples

- この **まま** で宜しいですか？
Is it ok **just like** this?

In other words, the clerk wants to know if you'll take it just like that or whether you want it in a small bag. 「宜しい」, in case I haven't gone over it yet, is simply a very polite version of 「いい」. Notice that 「まま」 grammatically works just like a regular noun which means, as usual, that you can modify it with verb phrases or adjectives.

- 半分しか **食べてないまま** で捨てちゃダメ！
You can't throw it out leaving it in that half-eaten condition!

Ok, the translation is very loose, but the idea is that it's in an unchanged state of being half-eaten and you can't just throw that out.

Here's a good example I found googling around.

Hint: The 「いさせる」 is the causative form of 「いる」 meaning "let/make me exist".

- 今日だけは **悲しいまま** でいさせてほしい。

For only today, I want you to let me stay in this sad condition.

Finally, just in case, here's an example of direct noun modification.

- その格好のままでクラブに入れないよ。

You can't get in the club in that getup (without changing it).

Using 「っぱなし」 to leave something the way it is

Vocabulary

1. 放す【はな・す】 (u-verb) - to release; to set loose
2. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
3. ほったらかす (u-verb) - to neglect
4. テレビ - TV, television
5. 開ける【あ・ける】 (ru-verb) - to open
6. 書く【か・く】 (u-verb) - to write
7. つける (ru-verb) - to attach; to turn on
8. する (exception) - to do
9. 眠れる【ねむ・れる】 (ru-verb) - to fall asleep
10. 人【ひと】 - person
11. 結構【けっ・こう】 - fairly, reasonably
12. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
13. 窓【まど】 - window
14. 蚊【か】 - mosquito
15. いっぱい - full
16. 入る【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter
17. しまう (u-verb) - to do something by accident; to finish completely

The verb 「放す」 meaning "to set loose", can be used in various ways in regards to leaving something the way it is. For instance, a variation 「放つとく」 is used when you want to say "Leave me alone". For instance, you might use the command form of a request (くれる) and say, 「ほっといてくれ！」 (Leave me alone!). Yet another variant 「ほったらかす」 means "to neglect".

The grammar I would like to discuss here is the 「っぱなし」 suffix variant. You can attach this suffix to the stem of any verb to describe the act of doing something and leaving it that way without changing it. You can treat the combination like a regular noun.

Here's a link with more [examples of this grammar](#). As you can see by the examples, this suffix carries a nuance that the thing left alone is due to oversight or neglect. Here are the (simple) conjugation rules for this grammar.

Using 「っぱなし」 to complete an action and leave it that way

Take the stem of the verb and attach 「っぱなし」.

Examples

1. 開ける → 開けっぱなし
2. 書く → 書き → 書きっぱなし

Examples

1. テレビをつけっぱなしにしなければ眠れない人は、結構いる。

There exists a fair number of people who cannot sleep unless they turn on the TV and leave it that way.

2. 窓が開けっ放しだったので、蚊がいっぱい入ってしまった。

The window was left wide open so a lot of mosquitoes got in.